

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Caste System: Structure and Contemporary Dynamics - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Caste System: Structure and Contemporary Dynamics - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session . . . 6

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT 6

BASIC LEARNING SESSION 6

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT 6

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL 7

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - VARNA, JATI AND THE LEVEL PROBLEM 8

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - THE FOUR DEFINING FEATURES 9

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - ENDOGAMY AND GOTRA EXOGAMY 10

SESSION 4 - CORE - LOCAL HIERARCHY AND PURITY-POLLUTION 12

SESSION 5 - CORE - OCCUPATIONAL DECOUPLING 13

SESSION 6 - CORE - SANSKRITISATION 15

SESSION 7 - CORE - WESTERNISATION AND THE CONTRAST 16

SESSION 8 - CORE - SRINIVAS'S VILLAGE EVIDENCE 17

SESSION 9 - CORE - THE DOMINANT CASTE 19

SESSION 10 - CORE - CASTE AND CLASS 20

SESSION 11 - CORE - ASSOCIATIONAL CASTE 22

SESSION 12 - CORE - THE FLUID-AND-STATIC PARADOX 24

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - SECT, CASTE AND ARENA-SPECIFIC SALIENCE 25

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - MARRIAGE BOUNDARIES AND THE CIVIL ROUTE 27

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - MEASUREMENT STATUS AND THE COMPLETE ANSWER SPINE 28

INDIAN SOCIETY DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL 37

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION 37

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Varna as ideal type? 37

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Varna as ideal type? 38

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Varna as ideal type? 38

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Varna as ideal type? 38

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Jati as the real unit? 38

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Jati as the real unit? 39

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Jati as the real unit? 39

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Jati as the real unit?	39
Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Four defining features?	39
Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Four defining features?	40
Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Four defining features?	40
Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Four defining features?	40
Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Endogamy with gotra exogamy?	40
Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Endogamy with gotra exogamy?	41
Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Endogamy with gotra exogamy?	41
Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Endogamy with gotra exogamy?	41
Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Locally variable hierarchy?	42
Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Locally variable hierarchy?	42
Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Locally variable hierarchy?	42
Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Locally variable hierarchy?	42
Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Occupational decoupling?	43
Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Occupational decoupling?	43
Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Occupational decoupling?	43
Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Occupational decoupling?	44
Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Sanskritisation?	44
Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Sanskritisation?	44
Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sanskritisation?	44
Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sanskritisation?	45
Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Westernisation?	45
Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Westernisation?	45
Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Westernisation?	46
Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Westernisation?	46
Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Rampura fieldwork?	46
Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Rampura fieldwork?	46
Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Rampura fieldwork?	47
Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Rampura fieldwork?	47
Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Dominant caste?	47
Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Dominant caste?	48
Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Dominant caste?	48

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Dominant caste?	48
Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Caste-class overlap and cross-cutting?	48
Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Caste-class overlap and cross-cutting?	49
Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Caste-class overlap and cross-cutting?	49
Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Caste-class overlap and cross-cutting?	49
Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Caste associations?	50
Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Caste associations?	50
Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Caste associations?	50
Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Caste associations?	50
Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Caste is not ethnicity?	51
Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Caste is not ethnicity?	51
Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Caste is not ethnicity?	51
Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Caste is not ethnicity?	52
Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Fluid rank and rigid boundary?	52
Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Fluid rank and rigid boundary?	52
Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Fluid rank and rigid boundary?	53
Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Fluid rank and rigid boundary?	53
Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Sect is not caste?	53
Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Sect is not caste?	54
Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sect is not caste?	54
Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sect is not caste?	54
Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Arena-specific salience?	55
Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Arena-specific salience?	55
Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Arena-specific salience?	55
Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Arena-specific salience?	56
Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Status-parity marriage mechanism?	56
Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Status-parity marriage mechanism?	56
Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Status-parity marriage mechanism?	57
Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Status-parity marriage mechanism?	57
Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Special Marriage Act civil route?	57
Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Special Marriage Act civil route?	58
Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Special Marriage Act civil route?	58

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Special Marriage Act civil route?	58
Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Caste-census measurement status?	58
Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Caste-census measurement status?	59
Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Caste-census measurement status?	59
Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Caste-census measurement status?	59
Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified direct Mains demands?	60
Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified direct Mains demands?	60
Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified direct Mains demands?	60
Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified direct Mains demands?	61
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	61
VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT	61
OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS	61
PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I Q9	63
PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 GS-I Q8	64
PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2020 GS-I Q8	66
PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 GS-I Q18	67
PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2023 GS-I Q19	68
ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS	70
ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS	71
ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS	72
ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS	74
ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS	75
ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS	77
OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER	78
CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES	83
Caste System: Structure and Contemporary Dynamics: RAPID CONCEPT AND EVIDENCE MAP	83
Caste System: Structure and Contemporary Dynamics: CLOSE-OPTION AND CAUSAL TRAPS	84
Caste System: Structure and Contemporary Dynamics: ANSWER-WRITING SPINE	85
Caste System: Structure and Contemporary Dynamics: CURRENT-LINK AND DATA BOUNDARY	85
COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM	85

Caste System: Structure and Contemporary Dynamics - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-02. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Generation date:** 2026-09-02.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was primary. The OCR-searchable official General Studies Paper-I question papers held under books\mains and books\more_previous_papers were used only to confirm the wording of routed Mains PYQs. No official answer key, marking scheme, page precision or unsupported quotation was imported from them.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner. The 2024 demand is routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to the Basic owner; the 2018, 2020, 2022 and 2023 demands are routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner, and the Core owner records that Core routing supersedes so that all five are answerable from the Basic spine. Every wording reproduced below was confirmed against the locally held official General Studies Paper-I question papers. No additional caste question, marking scheme or official key is invented, and no objective item is converted into a solved answer.
- **Live-link boundary:** No additional live official item was verified for this topic on 2026-09-02. Only the dated official anchors already carried by the repository owners are used, each with its issuing body and date. The package invents no caste, tribe, demographic or agrarian statistic, no legal or constitutional claim and no policy status.
- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

Control	Binding rule for this package
Syllabus boundary	Complete Indian Society Basic/Core is answer-complete before optional Advanced depth.
Concept method	Define and distinguish the institution, identity, process, legal category and measured indicator before analysis.
Sociological method	Structure/institution -> mechanism and agency -> differentiated group/region outcome -> feedback, resistance and qualification.
Evidence method	Claim -> named Indian community/region/institution/dataset -> analysis -> source-date-status or causal qualification.
Non-homogenisation	Caste, tribe, women, religion, region and rural/urban groups retain internal class, gender, locality and historical variation.
Boundary method	Constitutional right, statutory mandate, executive scheme, implementation and lived social outcome remain distinct.
Practice contract	Every solved item has demand decoding, a detailed examiner-grade model, executable timed/compression plan, marks rationale and answer-specific improvement.
Approval	This immutable successor remains approved: false pending explicit approval.

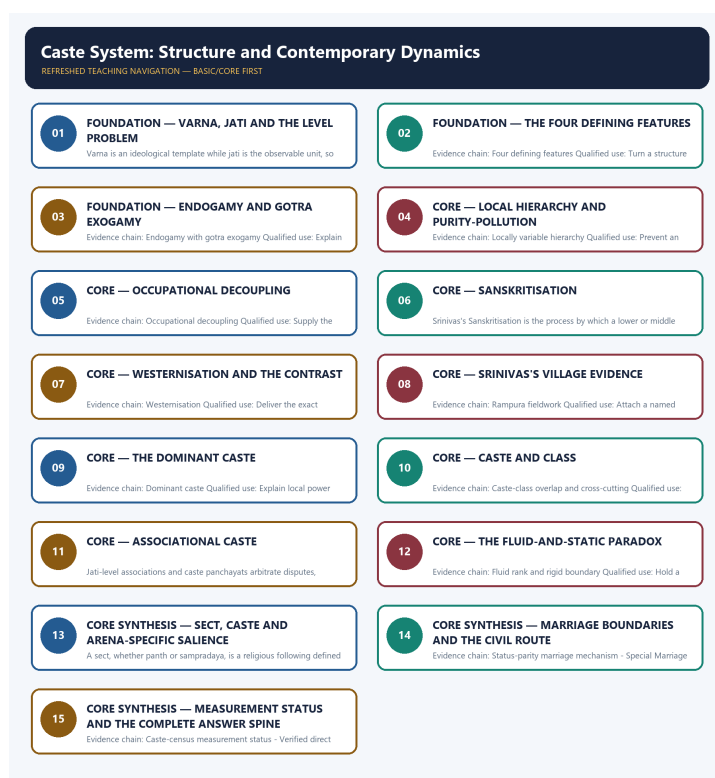
Canonical Basic/Core owner: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Indian-Society\basic\02_Caste-System-Structure-and-Contemporary-Dynamics.md **Canonical topic owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Indian-Society\basic\02_Caste-System-Structure-and-Contemporary-Dynamics.md **Optional Advanced owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Indian-Society\advanced\02_Caste-System-Structure-and-Contemporary-Dynamics.md

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

- **Definition discipline:** close concepts and legal-administrative categories share a comparison axis and are never treated as synonyms.
- **Mechanism discipline:** correlation, temporal sequence and aggregate association do not establish causation; identify institutions, incentives, norms, power and agency.
- **Historical discipline:** colonial, constitutional, developmental, liberalisation and contemporary phases are separated without a linear tradition-to-modernity story.
- **Intersectional discipline:** overlapping caste, tribe, class, gender, religion, disability, region and life-course positions are analysed without creating a single homogeneous category.
- **India discipline:** use named communities, movements, institutions, cities, states and regional contrasts without stereotyping or treating one case as nationally representative.
- **Data discipline:** Census 2011, NFHS, PLFS, SRS, Agriculture Census, MPI and scheme claims retain source, reference period, release date, coverage and provisional/final status.
- **PYQ discipline:** repository routing ledgers and locally held papers control wording and metadata; reconstructed wording and unavailable official keys remain labelled.
- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-02:** No additional live official item was verified for this topic on 2026-09-02. Only the dated official anchors already carried by the repository owners are used, each with its issuing body and date. The package invents no caste, tribe, demographic or agrarian statistic, no legal or constitutional claim and no policy status.

Live/official context sources recorded by the predecessor generation:

- No volatile live claim is necessary for the static sociological core.



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - VARNA, JATI AND THE LEVEL PROBLEM

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.

Technical definition: Varna is an ideological template while jati is the observable unit, so the two must not be merged.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- Varna
- jati
- the level problem
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Varna, connect jati with the level problem to explain the mechanism, and use Evidence chain for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

VARNA, JATI AND THE LEVEL PROBLEM

01. Varna as ideal type

|
v

02. Jati as the real unit

BOUNDARY -> Varna is an ideological template while jati is the observable unit, so the two must not be merged.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit.
- Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Varna is an ideological template while jati is the observable unit, so the two must not be merged.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Varna, jati and the level problem.
- **Mains:** Fix the level of analysis before any caste argument begins.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Varna as ideal type -> Jati as the real unit
- **Qualified use:** Fix the level of analysis before any caste argument begins.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - VARNA, JATI AND THE LEVEL PROBLEM

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Varna, jati and the level problem

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Varna · jati · the level problem · Evidence chain · Qualified use

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Varna as ideal type - Jati as the real unit Qualified use:
Fix the level of analysis before any caste argument begins.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Varna is an ideological template while jati is the observable unit, so the two must not be merged.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - THE FOUR DEFINING FEATURES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Four defining features Qualified use: Turn a structure question into a feature-by-feature assessment.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **The four defining features**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Endogamy**
- **Four**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define The four defining features, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Endogamy for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE FOUR DEFINING FEATURES

01. Four defining features

BOUNDARY -> The four features weaken at different rates, so they cannot be assessed as a single block.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The four features weaken at different rates, so they cannot be assessed as a single block.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to The four defining features.
- **Mains:** Turn a structure question into a feature-by-feature assessment.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Four defining features
- **Qualified use:** Turn a structure question into a feature-by-feature assessment.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - THE FOUR DEFINING FEATURES

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - The four defining features

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • The four defining features • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Endogamy • Four

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Four defining features Qualified use: Turn a structure question into a feature-by-feature assessment.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that turn a structure question into a feature-by-feature assessment.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: turn a structure question into a feature-by-feature assessment.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates.

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - ENDOGAMY AND GOTRA EXOGAMY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Endogamy with gotra exogamy Qualified use: Explain the reproduction mechanism that makes caste persist.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Endogamy with gotra exogamy Qualified use: Explain the reproduction mechanism that makes caste persist.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- Endogamy
- gotra exogamy
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Qualified

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Endogamy, connect gotra exogamy with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

ENDO GAMY AND GOTRA EXOGAMY

01. Endogamy with gotra exogamy

BOUNDARY -> The two rules operate at different levels and normally apply together.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The two rules operate at different levels and normally apply together.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Endogamy and gotra exogamy.
- **Mains:** Explain the reproduction mechanism that makes caste persist.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Endogamy with gotra exogamy
- **Qualified use:** Explain the reproduction mechanism that makes caste persist.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - ENDOGAMY AND GOTRA EXOGAMY

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Endogamy and gotra exogamy

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Endogamy · gotra exogamy · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Qualified

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Mains: Explain the reproduction mechanism that makes caste persist.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: endogamy with gotra exogamy Qualified use.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Endogamy with gotra exogamy Qualified use: Explain the reproduction mechanism that makes caste persist.

SESSION 4 - CORE - LOCAL HIERARCHY AND PURITY-POLLUTION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Locally variable hierarchy Qualified use: Prevent an over-generalised hierarchy claim in a structure answer.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Local hierarchy
- purity-pollution
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Jatis
- Indian

How to use them: Frame the answer through Local hierarchy; define purity-pollution, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Jatis for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

LOCAL HIERARCHY AND PURITY-POLLUTION

01. Locally variable hierarchy

BOUNDARY -> Rank order varies regionally, so no single national ladder can be asserted.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Rank order varies regionally, so no single national ladder can be asserted.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Local hierarchy and purity-pollution.
- **Mains:** Prevent an over-generalised hierarchy claim in a structure answer.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Locally variable hierarchy
- **Qualified use:** Prevent an over-generalised hierarchy claim in a structure answer.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - LOCAL HIERARCHY AND PURITY-POLLUTION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Local hierarchy and purity-pollution

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Local hierarchy · purity-pollution · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Jatis · Indian

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Locally variable hierarchy Qualified use: Prevent an over-generalised hierarchy claim in a structure answer.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Rank order varies regionally, so no single national ladder can be asserted.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

SESSION 5 - CORE - OCCUPATIONAL DECOUPLING

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Decoupling is uneven and stigmatised occupations have not disappeared.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Occupational decoupling Qualified use: Supply the fluid half of the fluid-and-static paradox.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Occupational decoupling
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Urbanisation
- Decoupling
- Occupational

How to use them: Frame the answer through Occupational decoupling; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Urbanisation to explain the mechanism, and use Decoupling for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

OCCUPATIONAL DECOUPLING

01. Occupational decoupling

BOUNDARY -> Decoupling is uneven and stigmatised occupations have not disappeared.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Decoupling is uneven and stigmatised occupations have not disappeared.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Occupational decoupling.
- **Mains:** Supply the fluid half of the fluid-and-static paradox.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Occupational decoupling
- **Qualified use:** Supply the fluid half of the fluid-and-static paradox.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - OCCUPATIONAL DECOUPLING

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Occupational decoupling

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Occupational decoupling • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Urbanisation • Decoupling • Occupational

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Occupational decoupling Qualified use: Supply the fluid half of the fluid-and-static paradox.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Decoupling is uneven and stigmatised occupations have not disappeared.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared.

SESSION 6 - CORE - SANSKRITISATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Sanskritisation is a status claim, not evidence that acceptance or income followed.

Technical definition: Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Sanskritisation Qualified use: Explain mobility that occurs inside hierarchy rather than against it.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Sanskritisation
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Srinivas's Sanskritisation
- Sanskritisation Qualified
- CORE - Sanskritisation

How to use them: Frame the answer through Sanskritisation; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Srinivas's Sanskritisation to explain the mechanism, and use Sanskritisation Qualified for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SANSKRITISATION

01. Sanskritisation

BOUNDARY -> Sanskritisation is a status claim, not evidence that acceptance or income followed.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Sanskritisation is a status claim, not evidence that acceptance or income followed.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Sanskritisation.
- **Mains:** Explain mobility that occurs inside hierarchy rather than against it.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Sanskritisation
- **Qualified use:** Explain mobility that occurs inside hierarchy rather than against it.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - SANSKRITISATION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Sanskritisation

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Sanskritisation • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Srinivas's Sanskritisation • Sanskritisation Qualified • CORE - Sanskritisation

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Sanskritisation is a status claim, not evidence that acceptance or income followed.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Mains: Explain mobility that occurs inside hierarchy rather than against it.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Sanskritisation Qualified use: Explain mobility that occurs inside hierarchy rather than against it.

SESSION 7 - CORE - WESTERNISATION AND THE CONTRAST

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Westernisation Qualified use: Deliver the exact distinction a comparison directive asks for.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Westernisation
- the contrast
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Srinivas's Westernisation
- Western

How to use them: Frame the answer through Westernisation; define the contrast, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Srinivas's Westernisation for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

WESTERNISATION AND THE CONTRAST

01. Westernisation

BOUNDARY -> Westernisation introduces new values and can contradict the hierarchy Sanskritisation assumes.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Westernisation introduces new values and can contradict the hierarchy Sanskritisation assumes.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Westernisation and the contrast.
- **Mains:** Deliver the exact distinction a comparison directive asks for.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Westernisation
- **Qualified use:** Deliver the exact distinction a comparison directive asks for.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - WESTERNISATION AND THE CONTRAST

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Westernisation and the contrast

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Westernisation · the contrast · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Srinivas's Westernisation · Western

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Westernisation Qualified use: Deliver the exact distinction a comparison directive asks for.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Westernisation introduces new values and can contradict the hierarchy Sanskritisation assumes.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: deliver the exact distinction a comparison directive asks for.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy.

SESSION 8 - CORE - SRINIVAS'S VILLAGE EVIDENCE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Rampura fieldwork Qualified use: Attach a named scholar and site to the mobility argument.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Srinivas's village evidence
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Srinivas
- Sanskritisation
- Rampura

How to use them: Frame the answer through Srinivas's village evidence; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Srinivas to explain the mechanism, and use Sanskritisation for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SRINIVAS'S VILLAGE EVIDENCE

01. Rampura fieldwork

BOUNDARY -> The concepts come from located fieldwork and must be attributed accurately.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The concepts come from located fieldwork and must be attributed accurately.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Srinivas's village evidence.
- **Mains:** Attach a named scholar and site to the mobility argument.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Rampura fieldwork
- **Qualified use:** Attach a named scholar and site to the mobility argument.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - SRINIVAS'S VILLAGE EVIDENCE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Srinivas's village evidence

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Srinivas's village evidence · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Srinivas · Sanskritisation · Rampura

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Rampura fieldwork Qualified use: Attach a named scholar and site to the mobility argument.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The concepts come from located fieldwork and must be attributed accurately.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.

SESSION 9 - CORE - THE DOMINANT CASTE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Dominant caste Qualified use: Explain local power without confusing it with ritual rank.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Dominant caste Qualified use: Explain local power without confusing it with ritual rank.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The dominant caste
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- A dominant caste
- Dominance
- Dominant

How to use them: Frame the answer through The dominant caste; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with A dominant caste to explain the mechanism, and use Dominance for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE DOMINANT CASTE

01. Dominant caste

BOUNDARY -> Dominance rests on numbers, land and office and can belong to a middle-ranked jati.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Dominance rests on numbers, land and office and can belong to a middle-ranked jati.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to The dominant caste.
- **Mains:** Explain local power without confusing it with ritual rank.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Dominant caste
- **Qualified use:** Explain local power without confusing it with ritual rank.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THE DOMINANT CASTE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - The dominant caste

|
v

EXACT TERMS: The dominant caste · Evidence chain · Qualified use · A dominant caste · Dominance · Dominant

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Dominance rests on numbers, land and office and can belong to a middle-ranked jati.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: explain local power without confusing it with ritual rank.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Dominant caste Qualified use: Explain local power without confusing it with ritual rank.

SESSION 10 - CORE - CASTE AND CLASS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Caste-class overlap and cross-cutting Qualified use: Handle caste-class questions without collapsing one into the other.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Caste
- class
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Overlap
- Caste-class

How to use them: Frame the answer through Caste; define class, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Overlap for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

CASTE AND CLASS

01. Caste-class overlap and cross-cutting

BOUNDARY -> Overlap is an empirical tendency that is loosening, not a definitional identity.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Overlap is an empirical tendency that is loosening, not a definitional identity.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Caste and class.
- **Mains:** Handle caste-class questions without collapsing one into the other.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Caste-class overlap and cross-cutting
- **Qualified use:** Handle caste-class questions without collapsing one into the other.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - CASTE AND CLASS

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Caste and class

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Caste · class · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Overlap · Caste-class

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Caste-class overlap and cross-cutting Qualified use: Handle caste-class questions without collapsing one into the other.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Overlap is an empirical tendency that is loosening, not a definitional identity.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.

SESSION 11 - CORE - ASSOCIATIONAL CASTE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Caste associations - Caste is not ethnicity Qualified use: Answer the associational-forms demand with mechanism and limit.

Technical definition: Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Caste associations - Caste is not ethnicity Qualified use: Answer the associational-forms demand with mechanism and limit.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Associational caste
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Jati-level
- Evidence chain: Caste associations - Caste
- Caste

How to use them: Frame the answer through Associational caste; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Jati-level to explain the mechanism, and use Evidence chain: Caste associations - Caste for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

ASSOCIATIONAL CASTE

01. Caste associations

|
v

02. Caste is not ethnicity

BOUNDARY -> Associational analysis supplements hierarchy analysis and never replaces it.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual.
- An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Associational analysis supplements hierarchy analysis and never replaces it.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Associational caste.
- **Mains:** Answer the associational-forms demand with mechanism and limit.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Caste associations -> Caste is not ethnicity
- **Qualified use:** Answer the associational-forms demand with mechanism and limit.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - ASSOCIATIONAL CASTE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Associational caste

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Associational caste · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Jati-level · Evidence chain:
Caste associations - Caste · Caste

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that caste associations - Caste is not ethnicity Qualified use.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: caste associations - Caste is not ethnicity Qualified use.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Caste associations - Caste is not ethnicity Qualified use: Answer the associational-forms demand with mechanism and limit.

SESSION 12 - CORE - THE FLUID-AND-STATIC PARADOX

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Fluidity and rigidity operate on different levels, so the paradox is resolved by level, not by choosing a side.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Fluid rank and rigid boundary Qualified use: Hold a paradox instead of choosing a side in a why directive.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Fluidity and rigidity operate on different levels, so the paradox is resolved by level, not by choosing a side.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The fluid
- static paradox
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Caste rank
- Caste

How to use them: Frame the answer through The fluid; define static paradox, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Caste rank for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE FLUID-AND-STATIC PARADOX

01. Fluid rank and rigid boundary

BOUNDARY -> Fluidity and rigidity operate on different levels, so the paradox is resolved by level, not by choosing a side.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Fluidity and rigidity operate on different levels, so the paradox is resolved by level, not by choosing a side.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to The fluid-and-static paradox.
- **Mains:** Hold a paradox instead of choosing a side in a why directive.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Fluid rank and rigid boundary
- **Qualified use:** Hold a paradox instead of choosing a side in a why directive.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THE FLUID-AND-STATIC PARADOX

START / CONCEPT: CORE - The fluid-and-static paradox

|

v

EXACT TERMS: The fluid · static paradox · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Caste rank · Caste

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Evidence chain: Fluid rank and rigid boundary Qualified use: Hold a paradox instead of choosing a side in a why directive.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: fluidity and rigidity operate on different levels, so the paradox is resolved by level...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Fluidity and rigidity operate on different levels, so the paradox is resolved by level, not by choosing a side.

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - SECT, CASTE AND ARENA-SPECIFIC SALIENCE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Sect is not caste - Arena-specific salience Qualified use: Rank competing identity axes by context rather than by assertion.

Technical definition: A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Sect is not caste - Arena-specific salience Qualified use: Rank competing identity axes by context rather than by assertion.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Sect
- caste
- arena-specific salience
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Sect, connect caste with arena-specific salience to explain the mechanism, and use Evidence chain for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SECT, CASTE AND ARENA-SPECIFIC SALIENCE

01. Sect is not caste

|
v

02. Arena-specific salience

BOUNDARY -> Salience is arena-specific, so a single national ranking of identity axes must be refused.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit.
- Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Salience is arena-specific, so a single national ranking of identity axes must be refused.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Sect, caste and arena-specific salience.
- **Mains:** Rank competing identity axes by context rather than by assertion.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Sect is not caste -> Arena-specific salience
- **Qualified use:** Rank competing identity axes by context rather than by assertion.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - SECT, CASTE AND ARENA-SPECIFIC SALIENCE

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Sect, caste and arena-specific salience

|
v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS • Sect • caste • arena-specific salience • Evidence chain • Qualified use

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: salience is arena-specific, so a single national ranking of identity axes must be refused.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Sect is not caste - Arena-specific salience Qualified use: Rank competing identity axes by context rather than by assertion.

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - MARRIAGE BOUNDARIES AND THE CIVIL ROUTE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The premise is qualified and the civil route shows personal law is not a sufficient explanation.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Status-parity marriage mechanism - Special Marriage Act civil route Qualified use: Explain a differential trend rather than marriage change in general.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Status-parity marriage mechanism - Special Marriage Act civil route Qualified use: Explain a differential trend rather than marriage change in general.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Marriage boundaries
- the civil route
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Where two jatis

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Marriage boundaries, connect the civil route with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

MARRIAGE BOUNDARIES AND THE CIVIL ROUTE

01. Status-parity marriage mechanism

|
v

02. Special Marriage Act civil route

BOUNDARY -> The premise is qualified and the civil route shows personal law is not a sufficient explanation.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings.
- The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The premise is qualified and the civil route shows personal law is not a sufficient explanation.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Marriage boundaries and the civil route.
- **Mains:** Explain a differential trend rather than marriage change in general.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Status-parity marriage mechanism -> Special Marriage Act civil route
- **Qualified use:** Explain a differential trend rather than marriage change in general.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - MARRIAGE BOUNDARIES AND THE CIVIL ROUTE

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Marriage boundaries and the civil route

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS • Marriage boundaries • the civil route • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Where two jatis

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The premise is qualified and the civil route shows personal law is not a sufficient explanation.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Status-parity marriage mechanism - Special Marriage Act civil route Qualified use: Explain a differential trend rather than marriage change in general.

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - MEASUREMENT STATUS AND THE COMPLETE ANSWER SPINE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Hierarchy as ranked status: ANALYSIS: jatis are locally ranked by notions of purity and pollution, though the exact rank order can vary from region to region.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Caste-census measurement status - Verified direct Mains demands Qualified use: Assemble the caste answer spine with an explicit measurement caveat.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Caste-census measurement status - Verified direct Mains demands Qualified use: Assemble the caste answer spine with an explicit measurement caveat.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **CORE SYNTHESIS**
- **Measurement status**
- **the complete answer spine**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Subject**

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Measurement status, connect the complete answer spine with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

MEASUREMENT STATUS AND THE COMPLETE ANSWER SPINE

01. Caste-census measurement status

|
v

02. Verified direct Mains demands

BOUNDARY -> The caste enumeration is prospective, so no caste figure may be quoted.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count.
- Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The caste enumeration is prospective, so no caste figure may be quoted.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Measurement status and the complete answer spine.
- **Mains:** Assemble the caste answer spine with an explicit measurement caveat.

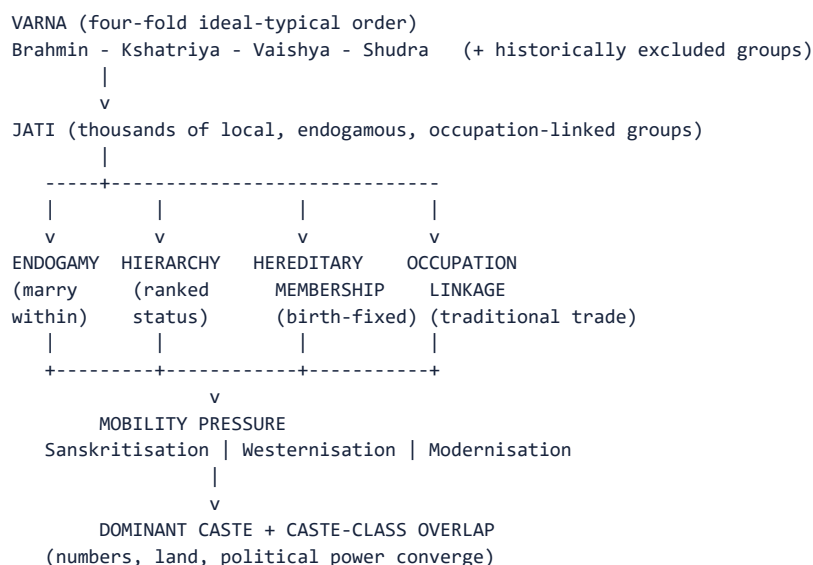
MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Caste-census measurement status -> Verified direct Mains demands
- **Qualified use:** Assemble the caste answer spine with an explicit measurement caveat.

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: Indian Society | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-I. **Core area:** Varna-jati structure, caste features, Sanskritisation/Westernisation, dominant caste and the intercaste-marriage trend. **Grounded in:** M.N. Srinivas's sociological framework (Sanskritisation, dominant caste, caste-class overlap); Census 2027 Gazette/PIB caste-enumeration announcement; audited 2024 GS-I PYQ. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference | **CURRENT:** = current anchor. *Companion:* advanced/02_Caste-System-Structure-and-Contemporary-Dynamics.md.

1. Visual foundation



Core proposition: FACT: Caste is a jati-level lived reality organised loosely around the varna ideal, defined by endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and occupational association, and its contemporary dynamics are driven by mobility strategies (Sanskritisation, Westernisation) and the rise of dominant castes that fuse ritual status with economic and political power.

2. Essential definitions

Concept	Exam-ready meaning
FACT: Varna	The four-fold ideal-typical classical order (Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya, Shudra) described in ancient texts; a normative scheme, not a directly observable social unit.
FACT: Jati	The actual, local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste; thousands of jatis exist, each locally ranked.
FACT: Endogamy	The rule of marrying within one's own jati (or sub-group), the single most consistently observed feature of caste.
FACT: Sanskritisation (M.N. Srinivas)	The process by which a lower or middle caste adopts customs, rituals and lifestyle associated with a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status. It is a claim to mobility, not proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.
FACT: Westernisation (M.N. Srinivas)	Change in Indian society and culture from sustained contact with Western (particularly British) values, technology and institutions - distinct from Sanskritisation because it introduces new values (equality, rationality) rather than emulating existing local hierarchy.
FACT: Dominant caste (M.N. Srinivas)	A caste that is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land, and wields political influence in a region, whether or not it ranks highest ritually.
ANALYSIS: Caste-class overlap	The empirical tendency for caste rank and economic class to coincide in a given locality, though the overlap is loosening in urban and market settings.

3. How the caste system is structured and changes

- Varna as ideology, jati as unit:** the four varnas provide a shared ideological template, but everyday caste life happens at the jati level, with local, not pan-Indian, hierarchies.
- Endogamy as the boundary marker:** FACT: marriage within the jati (or an approved sub-group) is the mechanism that keeps caste boundaries intact across generations.
- Hierarchy as ranked status:** ANALYSIS: jatis are locally ranked by notions of purity and

pollution, though the exact rank order can vary from region to region.

4. **Occupation as traditional linkage:** FACT: many jatis were historically linked to a specific traditional occupation, though this linkage has weakened sharply with urbanisation, education and non-farm employment.

5. **Sanskritisation as upward mobility:** FACT: a jati may emulate dietary, ritual or marriage practices associated with a locally higher-status caste to claim a higher position without waiting for state reclassification. The practices, acceptance and consequences vary by region.

6. **Westernisation as parallel change:** FACT: exposure to Western education, law and institutions introduces values such as individual equality and rationality that can coexist with, reinforce or contradict Sanskritising trends in the same community.

7. **Dominant caste as power convergence:** FACT: where numbers, land and political office converge in one caste, that caste's local influence often exceeds its ritual rank - Srinivas identified this as the practical centre of village power in many regions.

4. Institutions and concepts

- FACT: **Jajmani-linked caste occupation:** historically, some jatis provided hereditary services (barber, washerman, priest) to landholding patron households - the jajmani system itself is treated in 05_Rural-Society-and-Agrarian-Change.md.

- FACT: **Caste associations and panchayats:** jati-level bodies that enforce endogamy norms, arbitrate disputes and, increasingly, organise political mobilisation.

- ANALYSIS: **Caste in urban/political life:** in cities and electoral politics, caste can be mobilised as an identity-and-interest network even where ritual-purity practices weaken. This does not make caste identical to ethnicity or erase hierarchy, endogamy and discrimination.

- ANALYSIS: **Caste-census debate (sociological angle only):** the demand to enumerate caste in the Census reflects a push to make caste-based disadvantage statistically visible; the enumeration mechanics themselves are a Census/Polity matter, not treated here.

- FACT: **Reservation and atrocity-protection law:** exists to address caste disadvantage but its constitutional doctrine and statutory detail belong to Polity and Social-Justice/basic/07_Scheduled-Castes-Rights-Atrocities-and-Welfare.md.

5. Indian applications and PYQ mapping

- FACT: **2024 GS-I PYQ (10 marks, verbatim):** "Intercaste marriages between castes which have socio-economic parity have increased, to some extent, but this is less true of interreligious marriages. Discuss." The expected answer: intercaste marriage between castes of similar socio-economic standing is increasingly tolerated because it does not threaten either family's status or resource base, whereas interreligious marriage crosses a boundary tied to community identity, personal law and often deeper social sanction, making it far less accepted even when economic parity exists - caste boundary-crossing is becoming a status-parity question, while religious boundary-crossing remains an identity-and-belonging question.

- ANALYSIS: A locally dominant landholding caste retaining political control of a Panchayat despite a numerically larger but dispersed lower-caste population illustrates the dominant-caste concept in practice.

6. Must-Know Facts for Prelims

- FACT: M.N. Srinivas coined both "Sanskritisation" and "dominant caste" based on his fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka.

- FACT: Sanskritisation is upward emulation within the existing hierarchy; Westernisation introduces new values from Western contact - the two can occur together or separately.

- FACT: Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupation-linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste.

- FACT: Reservation and SC/ST atrocity-protection law are Polity/Social-Justice territory, not restated here.

- CURRENT: The Government has announced caste enumeration in Census 2027. The operation is prospective as of 21 July 2026; no results exist. It is not the first caste enumeration in Indian history, although post-Independence Censuses did not enumerate all castes.

7. UPSC traps

- WRONG: Varna and jati are the same thing. -> Varna is a four-fold textual ideal type; jati is the real, local, endogamous social unit - thousands of jatis exist within or alongside the varna framework.

- WRONG: Sanskritisation and Westernisation are interchangeable terms for "modernisation." -> Sanskritisation is emulation of existing dominant-caste ritual status; Westernisation introduces new Western-origin values; both differ from modernisation, which implies structural, rational-institutional change (Topic 12).

- WRONG: Dominant caste always means the ritually highest caste. -> Dominance rests on numbers, land and political power, which can belong to a middle-ranked caste that is locally numerous and land-owning, not necessarily the ritually top-ranked caste.

- WRONG: Intercaste and interreligious marriage face the same level of social acceptance. -> The 2024 PYQ specifically distinguishes them: intercaste marriage with socio-economic parity is increasingly accepted, interreligious marriage remains far less so.

8. CURRENT: Current anchor

- CURRENT: Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas, and 1 March 2027 elsewhere; PIB announced caste enumeration. No caste-count data exists to cite as of 21 July 2026. Distinguish this announced operation from earlier historical caste enumerations.

9. PYQ application

- FACT: **2024 GS-I (10 marks):** answer structure - define the caste-marriage vs religion-marriage boundary distinction, give the socio-economic-parity condition for intercaste acceptance, explain why religious boundary-crossing carries added identity/personal-law weight, and conclude with the differential-pace observation.

10. Mains angles

- ANALYSIS: Use Sanskritisation/Westernisation/dominant caste as the three anchor concepts for any caste-mobility question.

- ANALYSIS: Keep reservation/atrocity-law doctrine out of Society answers; cross-refer instead.

- ANALYSIS: Frame intercaste-marriage trends around status-parity, not blanket "caste is disappearing" claims; the PYQ's qualified premise is not a national prevalence series.

Answer thesis: Caste in contemporary India survives as a jati-level, endogamy-anchored structure whose mobility is now driven by Sanskritisation, Westernisation and dominant-caste convergence of numbers-land-power; intercaste marriage is loosening where socio-economic parity exists, but interreligious marriage remains constrained by deeper identity and personal-law boundaries, showing caste and religious boundaries erode at different paces.

11. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Who coined the terms "Sanskritisation" and "dominant caste"?

- FACT: **Mains (10 marks, 2024 GS-I PYQ, verbatim):** Intercaste marriages between castes which have socio-economic parity have increased, to some extent, but this is less true of interreligious marriages. Discuss.

- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** Distinguish between Sanskritisation and Westernisation with examples.

- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** Explain the concept of "dominant caste" and its relevance to understanding local power structures in rural India.

12. Study links

- FACT: Advanced companion:
advanced/02_Caste-System-Structure-and-Contemporary-Dynamics.md.
- FACT: 05_Rural-Society-and-Agrarian-Change.md - jajmani system and dominant-caste-in-village power (do not re-derive here).
- FACT: 04_Family-Marriage-and-Kinship.md - the interreligious-marriage half of the 2024 PYQ.
- FACT: Social-Justice/basic/07_Scheduled-Castes-Rights-Atrocities-and-Welfare.md - welfare law and atrocity protection (Polity/Social-Justice territory, not restated here).
- FACT: 12_Social-Change-and-Modernisation.md - Sanskritisation/Westernisation placed within the broader theory of social change.

13. Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

Core-only. Caste questions in GS-I cluster into five recurring demand families - **structure, mobility, fluidity/persistence, associational politics, and boundary-crossing marriage**. All five are executable from this section without advanced/02.

13.1 Directive-to-structure map

Directive	What is tested	Structure that scores
Comment (caste assuming new identities and associational forms)	Whether you can show <i>change of form</i> without claiming <i>disappearance</i>	Old form -> what weakened -> what replaced it -> what did not change -> verdict
Elaborate with illustrations (relevance of caste in a multi-cultural society)	Whether caste is analysed as a live organising principle, not a relic	Four arenas: marriage, ritual, economy, politics - one illustration each
Why / Analyse (caste as both fluid and static)	Whether you can hold a paradox instead of choosing a side	Two columns: what is fluid vs what is static, then the <i>level</i> explanation
Analyse (salience of sect against caste, region, religion)	Whether you can rank competing identity axes by context	Define each axis -> state the contexts where each dominates -> refuse a single ranking
Discuss (intercaste vs interreligious marriage)	Whether you explain <i>differential</i> pace, not marriage in general	Parity condition -> identity condition -> why the two boundaries erode at different speeds

13.2 Thesis bank

- **T1 (change questions):** FACT: Caste is not dissolving; it is **changing register** - from ritual hierarchy and occupational allocation towards associational identity, network capital and political mobilisation, while endogamy remains the least-changed feature.
- **T2 (fluid/static questions):** ANALYSIS: Caste is **fluid in status and rigid in boundary**: a jati can renegotiate its *rank* (Sanskritisation, political assertion, market position) far more easily than it can dissolve its *marriage boundary*.
- **T3 (multi-cultural relevance):** ANALYSIS: Caste remains analytically indispensable because it is the axis on which India's cultural plurality is *stratified*, not merely differentiated.
- **T4 (marriage questions):** FACT: Caste boundaries are becoming a **status-parity** question; religious boundaries remain an **identity-and-belonging** question - hence the divergent trend the 2024 PYQ describes.

13.3 Mark-scaled spines

10 marks - "Caste is assuming new identities and associational forms; comment."

1. T1 as opening. 2. What weakened: occupational allocation, jajmani service ties, public purity-pollution enforcement. 3. What replaced it: caste associations, welfare and educational trusts, electoral blocs, urban networks for jobs and housing. 4. What did not change: endogamy, and discrimination in intimate and residential spheres.

5. Qualification: variation by region, urban-rural location and class. 6. Verdict - form change, not disappearance.

10 marks - "Intercaste marriages between castes with socio-economic parity have increased... less true of interreligious marriages. Discuss." (2024 GS-I Q9)

1. Frame the divergence as the question, not marriage change in general. 2. Parity mechanism: where two jatis are of similar standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status or resource base. 3. Identity mechanism: religious boundary-crossing engages community belonging and personal-law plurality, so parity is insufficient. 4. Note the **Special Marriage Act** civil route, so personal-law plurality alone is not the full explanation. 5. Qualification - a qualified PYQ premise, not a national prevalence series.

6. Verdict - the two boundaries erode at different speeds because they are guarded by different things.

15 marks - "Caste identity in India is both fluid and static. Why?"

1. T2. 2. **Static layer:** endogamy as the reproduction mechanism (E1); hereditary membership; residential and marital segregation. 3. **Fluid layer:** Sanskritisation as a status claim (E2); dominant-caste power built on numbers-land-office (E3); market and urban occupational mobility (E4); associational and electoral reinvention (E5). 4. **The level explanation:** rank is negotiable because it is *locally* constructed; boundary is not, because it is reproduced through marriage. 5. Measurement point: no all-India jati count exists to quote, and Census 2027 caste enumeration is prospective (E6). 6. Verdict.

20 marks - "Assess whether caste is best understood today as hierarchy, as identity, or as network." Add: the varna-jati distinction as the level problem; the three readings set against each other with one arena each (ritual, politics, labour market); the caste-class overlap and its loosening; a synthesis that no single reading covers all four arenas; cross-links to 08_Social-Empowerment.md (capability), 05 (village power) and Polity/Social-Justice for reservation doctrine, each labelled as a borrowing.

13.4 Evidence bank - claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation

- **E1 - Endogamy is the reproduction mechanism.** *Claim:* caste survives because marriage reproduces it. *Evidence:* endogamy is the most consistently observed of the four classic features (endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership, occupational linkage), operating together with **gotra exogamy** - marriage within the jati but outside the clan. *Significance:* explains why occupational and ritual change has not dissolved caste. *Limitation:* practice varies by region, class and generation; the 2024 PYQ premise is qualified ("to some extent") and is not a prevalence series.

- **E2 - Sanskritisation.** *Claim:* mobility can occur *within* hierarchy without changing it. *Evidence:* **M.N. Srinivas**, from fieldwork at **Rampura, Karnataka**, described a jati adopting the diet, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim rank. *Significance:* shows status is locally negotiable and that mobility strategy can *reinforce* the hierarchy's logic. *Limitation:* it is a **claim** to status, not proof of acceptance or of material mobility; regional variation is large.

- **E3 - Dominant caste.** *Claim:* practical power need not follow ritual rank. *Evidence:* Srinivas's dominant caste - numerically strong, holding a significant share of local land, wielding political influence - often a middle-ranked jati. *Significance:* the operative unit for village power analysis and for Panchayat-level questions. *Limitation:* reserved seats for SCs, STs and women in Panchayats now contest this control without eliminating it.

- **E4 - Occupational decoupling.** *Claim:* the caste-occupation link is the weakest joint. *Evidence:* urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, while the **jajmani** service tie (treated in 05) has been displaced by cash-wage work. *Significance:* supplies the "fluid"

half of the paradox. *Limitation*: stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared; do not claim uniform decoupling.

- **E5 - Associational reinvention.** *Claim*: caste is re-entering public life as organisation, not as ritual. *Evidence*: caste associations and jati panchayats that arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy and organise political mobilisation; caste as an identity-and-interest network in urban and electoral life. *Significance*: the direct answer to "new identities and associational forms". *Limitation*: this does **not** make caste equivalent to ethnicity - hierarchy, endogamy and discrimination persist alongside.

- **E6 - Measurement status.** *Claim*: caste disadvantage remains statistically under-mapped. *Evidence*: **PIB (30 April 2025)** announced caste enumeration in **Census 2027**; **Gazette S.O. 2681(E)** fixes the reference dates. *Significance*: the visibility argument is itself an answer point in caste-census questions. *Limitation*: prospective - no caste-count figure exists; and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating **all** castes does not make this India's first historical caste count.

13.5 Sect, sub-caste and the identity-ranking demand

ANALYSIS: Examiners have asked which identity axis is most salient. Hold these apart:

Axis	Unit	Boundary rule	When it dominates
Varna	Four-fold textual ideal type	Normative, not observable	Ideological and comparative argument
Jati	Local endogamous birth group	Endogamy	Marriage, local status, village power
Sub-caste / sub-jati	Segment within a jati	Narrower endogamy circle	Marriage negotiation, association membership
Sect (panth/sampradaya)	Voluntary or inherited religious following within or across a faith	Doctrine, guru lineage, initiation - not birth-endogamy in the caste sense	Ritual life, sacred-site politics, devotional identity
Religion	Faith community	Belief and belonging	Communal mobilisation (13), personal law (04)
Region/language	Territorial-cultural group	Territory and speech	Regional assertion (14)

ANALYSIS: **Answer rule**: sect is a *religious-following* axis and caste a *birth-and-marriage* axis; they can overlap (a jati concentrated in one sect) without being the same thing. Refuse a single national ranking - state instead that salience is **arena-specific**: marriage -> jati; devotional and shrine politics -> sect; electoral mobilisation -> jati cluster and religion; development grievance -> region.

13.6 Balance bank

- ANALYSIS: **Against "caste is disappearing"**: endogamy persists; associational and electoral caste is expanding, not contracting.
- ANALYSIS: **Against "caste is unchanged"**: occupational allocation and public purity enforcement have weakened sharply; urban labour markets recruit on credentials.
- ANALYSIS: **Against "caste = class"**: the overlap is empirical and loosening, not definitional; a rich lower-caste household and a poor dominant-caste household both exist.
- ANALYSIS: **Against "caste = ethnicity"**: ethnic framing drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct.
- ANALYSIS: **Scope discipline**: reservation doctrine, atrocity law and quantum questions belong to Polity and Social-Justice/basic/07; do not re-derive them in a Society answer.

13.7 Verdict scaffolds

- **Form-change verdict**: "Caste has changed its register rather than its existence: what was hierarchy and occupation has become identity, association and network, while the marriage boundary - the mechanism that reproduces caste - has changed least."

- **Paradox verdict:** "Caste is fluid where status is locally constructed and static where reproduction is marital; that is why the same society can show rising intercaste marriage and undiminished caste identity simultaneously."
- **Divergence verdict:** "Parity is loosening the caste boundary; belonging is holding the religious one - the divergence the 2024 question describes is a difference in what each boundary protects, not a difference in the pace of modernity."

13.8 Direct Mains demands this Core file must answer alone

Year · Paper · Q	Demand	Authoritative ledger owner	Core route
2024 · GS-I · Q9	Intercaste versus interreligious marriages	Indian-Society/basic/02 FACT: this file	§13.3 10-mark spine; family half in 04 §13
2018 · GS-I · Q8	Caste assuming new identities and associational forms	ledger points to advanced/02	Core routing supersedes: §13.3 10-mark spine + E5
2020 · GS-I · Q8	Relevance of caste in understanding multi-cultural Indian society	ledger points to advanced/02	Core routing supersedes: T3 + four-arena structure §13.1
2022 · GS-I · Q18	Salience of sect against caste, region and religion	ledger points to advanced/02	Core routing supersedes: §13.5 identity-ranking table
2023 · GS-I · Q19	Caste identity as both fluid and static	ledger points to advanced/02	Core routing supersedes: §13.3 15-mark spine (T2)

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-I	9	Intercaste versus interreligious marriages	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Intercaste versus interreligious marriages

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - MEASUREMENT STATUS AND THE COMPLETE ANSWER SPINE

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Measurement status and the complete answer spine

|
v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Measurement status · the complete answer spine · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Subject

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Hierarchy as ranked status: ANALYSIS: jatis are locally ranked by notions of purity and pollution, though the exact rank order can vary from region to region.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Limitation: it is a claim to status, not proof of acceptance or of material mobility; regional variation is large.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Discuss." The expected answer: intercaste marriage between castes of similar socio-economic standing is increasingly tolerated because it does not threaten either family's status or resource base, whereas interreligious marriage crosses a boundary tied to community identity, personal law and often deeper social sanction, making it far less accepted even when economic parity exists - caste boundary-crossing is becoming a status-parity question, while religious boundary-crossing remains an identity-and-belonging question. ANALYSIS: A locally dominant landholding caste retaining political control of a Panchayat despite a numerically larger but dispersed lower-caste population illustrates the dominant-caste concept in practice.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Caste-census measurement status - Verified direct Mains demands Qualified use: Assemble the caste answer spine with an explicit measurement caveat.

INDIAN SOCIETY DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** Caste joins varna ideology, locally ranked jatis, endogamy, hereditary occupation, purity-pollution, social closure and power; Sanskritisation, dominant caste, secularisation, politicisation and caste-class mobility explain change without implying disappearance.
- **Close distinction:** Varna is not jati, caste is not class, ritual rank is not identical to economic or political power, untouchability is not every caste inequality, and constitutional Scheduled Caste status is a legal-administrative category rather than a complete sociological map.
- **Evidence / interpretation limit:** Articles 15-17, 46, 330-342A and reservation institutions set legal boundaries, but legal prohibition does not equal social eradication; compare Jat, Maratha, Patidar, Dalit and regional caste dynamics without homogenising communities or inferring causes from aggregate correlations.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Varna as ideal type?

A. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. B. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. C. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. D. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.

Answer: A. Explanation: Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Varna as ideal type?

A. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. B. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. C. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. D. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

Answer: B. Explanation: Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Varna as ideal type?

A. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. B. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. C. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. D. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

Answer: C. Explanation: Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Varna as ideal type?

A. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. B. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. C. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. D. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit.

Answer: D. Explanation: Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Jati as the real unit?

A. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. B. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. C. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. D. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

Answer: A. Explanation: Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Jati as the real unit?

A. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. B. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. C. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. D. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

Answer: B. Explanation: Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Jati as the real unit?

A. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. B. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. C. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. D. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

Answer: C. Explanation: Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Jati as the real unit?

A. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. B. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. C. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. D. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.

Answer: D. Explanation: Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Four defining features?

A. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. B. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. C. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. D. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

Answer: A. Explanation: Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. The remaining

options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Four defining features?

A. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. B. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. C. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. D. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

Answer: B. Explanation: Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Four defining features?

A. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. B. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. C. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. D. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.

Answer: C. Explanation: Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Four defining features?

A. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. B. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. C. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. D. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates.

Answer: D. Explanation: Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Endogamy with gotra exogamy?

A. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. B. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. C. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. D. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

Answer: A. Explanation: Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Endogamy with gotra exogamy?

A. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. B. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. C. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. D. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy.

Answer: B. Explanation: Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Endogamy with gotra exogamy?

A. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. B. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. C. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. D. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.

Answer: C. Explanation: Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Endogamy with gotra exogamy?

A. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. B. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. C. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. D. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

Answer: D. Explanation: Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Locally variable hierarchy?

A. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. B. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. C. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. D. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.

Answer: A. Explanation: Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Locally variable hierarchy?

A. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. B. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. C. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. D. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.

Answer: B. Explanation: Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Locally variable hierarchy?

A. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. B. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. C. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. D. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy.

Answer: C. Explanation: Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Locally variable hierarchy?

A. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. B. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. C. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. D. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

Answer: D. Explanation: Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. The remaining

options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Occupational decoupling?

A. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. B. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. C. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. D. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.

Answer: A. Explanation: Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Occupational decoupling?

A. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. B. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. C. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. D. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.

Answer: B. Explanation: Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Occupational decoupling?

A. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. B. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. C. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. D. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.

Answer: C. Explanation: Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Occupational decoupling?

A. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. B. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. C. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. D. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared.

Answer: D. Explanation: Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Sanskritisation?

A. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. B. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. C. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. D. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy.

Answer: A. Explanation: M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Sanskritisation?

A. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. B. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. C. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. D. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank.

Answer: B. Explanation: M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sanskritisation?

A. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. B. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. C. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. D. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday

local power than ritual rank.

Answer: C. Explanation: M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sanskritisation?

A. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. B. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. C. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. D. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.

Answer: D. Explanation: M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Westernisation?

A. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. B. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. C. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. D. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.

Answer: A. Explanation: Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Westernisation?

A. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. B. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. C. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. D. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.

Answer: B. Explanation: Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Westernisation?

A. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. B. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. C. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. D. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.

Answer: C. Explanation: Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Westernisation?

A. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. B. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. C. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. D. Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy.

Answer: D. Explanation: Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Rampura fieldwork?

A. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. B. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. C. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. D. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank.

Answer: A. Explanation: Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Rampura fieldwork?

A. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. B. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. C. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. D. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis.

Answer: B. Explanation: Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Rampura fieldwork?

A. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. B. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. C. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. D. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis.

Answer: C. Explanation: Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Rampura fieldwork?

A. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. B. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. C. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. D. Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.

Answer: D. Explanation: Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Dominant caste?

A. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. B. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. C. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. D. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.

Answer: A. Explanation: A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Dominant caste?

A. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. B. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. C. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. D. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

Answer: B. Explanation: A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Dominant caste?

A. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. B. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. C. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. D. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

Answer: C. Explanation: A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Dominant caste?

A. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. B. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. C. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. D. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank.

Answer: D. Explanation: A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Caste-class overlap and cross-cutting?

A. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. B. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. C. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. D. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual.

Answer: A. Explanation: Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Caste-class overlap and cross-cutting?

A. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. B. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. C. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. D. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

Answer: B. Explanation: Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Caste-class overlap and cross-cutting?

A. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. B. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. C. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. D. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

Answer: C. Explanation: Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Caste-class overlap and cross-cutting?

A. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. B. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. C. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. D. Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.

Answer: D. Explanation: Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Caste associations?

A. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. B. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. C. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. D. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

Answer: A. Explanation: Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Caste associations?

A. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. B. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. C. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. D. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit.

Answer: B. Explanation: Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Caste associations?

A. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. B. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. C. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. D. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings.

Answer: C. Explanation: Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Caste associations?

A. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. B. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. C. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. D. Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual.

Answer: D. Explanation: Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Caste is not ethnicity?

A. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. B. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. C. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. D. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

Answer: A. Explanation: An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Caste is not ethnicity?

A. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. B. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. C. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. D. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings.

Answer: B. Explanation: An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Caste is not ethnicity?

A. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. B. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. C. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. D. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance.

Answer: C. Explanation: An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Caste is not ethnicity?

A. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. B. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. C. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. D. An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis.

Answer: D. Explanation: An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Fluid rank and rigid boundary?

A. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. B. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. C. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. D. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit.

Answer: A. Explanation: Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Fluid rank and rigid boundary?

A. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. B. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. C. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. D. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead.

Answer: B. Explanation: Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Fluid rank and rigid boundary?

A. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. B. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. C. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. D. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead.

Answer: C. Explanation: Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Fluid rank and rigid boundary?

A. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. B. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. C. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. D. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

Answer: D. Explanation: Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Sect is not caste?

A. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. B. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. C. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. D. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings.

Answer: A. Explanation: A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Sect is not caste?

A. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. B. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. C. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. D. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count.

Answer: B. Explanation: A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sect is not caste?

A. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. B. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. C. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. D. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead.

Answer: C. Explanation: A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sect is not caste?

A. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. B. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. C. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. D. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit.

Answer: D. Explanation: A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Arena-specific salience?

A. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. B. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. C. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. D. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings.

Answer: A. Explanation: Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Arena-specific salience?

A. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. B. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. C. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. D. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count.

Answer: B. Explanation: Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Arena-specific salience?

A. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. B. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. C. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. D. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15.

Answer: C. Explanation: Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Arena-specific salience?

A. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. B. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. C. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. D. Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance.

Answer: D. Explanation: Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Status-parity marriage mechanism?

A. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. B. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. C. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. D. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15.

Answer: A. Explanation: Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Status-parity marriage mechanism?

A. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. B. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. C. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. D. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15.

Answer: B. Explanation: Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Status-parity marriage mechanism?

A. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. B. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. C. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. D. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15.

Answer: C. Explanation: Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Status-parity marriage mechanism?

A. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. B. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. C. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. D. Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings.

Answer: D. Explanation: Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Special Marriage Act civil route?

A. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. B. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. C. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. D. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Special Marriage Act civil route?

A. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. B. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. C. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. D. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Special Marriage Act civil route?

A. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. B. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. C. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. D. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Special Marriage Act civil route?

A. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. B. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. C. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. D. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Caste-census measurement status?

A. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. B. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. C. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. D. Varna is

the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Caste-census measurement status?

A. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. B. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. C. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. D. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Caste-census measurement status?

A. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. B. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. C. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. D. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Caste-census measurement status?

A. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. B. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. C. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. D. The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make

this India's first historical caste count. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. B. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. C. Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit. D. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.

Answer: A. Explanation: Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. B. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. C. Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework. D. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

Answer: B. Explanation: Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. B. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. C. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. D. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

Answer: C. Explanation: Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. B. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. C. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. D. Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15.

Answer: D. Explanation: Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner. The 2024 demand is routed in the audited 2024-2025 ledger to the Basic owner; the 2018, 2020, 2022 and 2023 demands are routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner, and the Core owner records that Core routing supersedes so that all five are answerable from the Basic spine. Every wording reproduced below was confirmed against the locally held official General Studies Paper-I question papers. No additional caste question, marking scheme or official key is invented, and no objective item is converted into a solved answer.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

5. Indian applications and PYQ mapping

- **FACT: 2024 GS-I PYQ (10 marks, verbatim):** "Intercaste marriages between castes which have socio-economic parity have increased, to some extent, but this is less true of interreligious marriages. Discuss." The expected answer: intercaste marriage between castes of similar socio-economic standing is increasingly tolerated because it does not threaten either family's status or resource base, whereas interreligious marriage crosses a boundary tied to community identity, personal law and often deeper social sanction, making it far less accepted even when economic parity exists - caste boundary-crossing is becoming a status-parity question, while religious boundary-crossing remains an identity-and-belonging question.

- **ANALYSIS:** A locally dominant landholding caste retaining political control of a Panchayat despite a numerically larger but dispersed lower-caste population illustrates the dominant-caste concept in practice.

9. PYQ application

- **FACT: 2024 GS-I (10 marks):** answer structure - define the caste-marriage vs religion-marriage boundary distinction, give the socio-economic-parity condition for intercaste acceptance, explain why religious boundary-crossing carries added identity/personal-law weight, and conclude with the differential-pace observation.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-I	9	Intercaste versus interreligious marriages	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Intercaste versus interreligious marriages

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- **FACT: 2024 GS-I (10 marks, verbatim):** "Intercaste marriages between castes which have socio-economic parity have increased, to some extent, but this is less true of interreligious marriages. Discuss." Analytical route: (a) apply the status-parity versus community-boundary distinction; (b) explain why parity may matter for some intercaste matches without universalising it; (c) explain interreligious resistance through community-belonging and kinship boundaries while noting the Special Marriage Act's civil route; (d) conclude that the qualified pattern needs region- and class-sensitive evidence, not a uniform "modernisation" story.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2020, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 4

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-I	8	Caste assuming new identities and associational forms	Comment · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2020	GS-I	8	Relevance of caste in understanding multi-cultural Indian society	Elaborate with illustrations · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-I	18	Salience of sect in Indian society against caste region and religion	Analyse · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-I	19	Caste identity in India as both fluid and static	Why · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Caste assuming new identities and associational forms
- Relevance of caste in understanding multi-cultural Indian society
- Salience of sect in Indian society against caste region and religion
- Caste identity in India as both fluid and static

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I Q9

Demand: Intercaste marriages between castes which have socio-economic parity have increased, to some extent, but this is less true of interreligious marriages. Discuss. (Answer in 150 words) 10 marks.

Status: Verified verbatim in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger and in the locally held official 2024 General Studies Paper-I.

Model solution: Frame the divergence rather than marriage change in general. Claim one: parity loosens the caste boundary, because where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which converts caste boundary-crossing into a status calculation; the qualification is that the premise is explicitly hedged as increasing only to some extent and is not a national prevalence series. Claim two: belonging holds the religious boundary, because interreligious marriage engages community identity, kinship networks and family sanction that economic parity does not remove; the named evidence that personal-law plurality alone is insufficient is the Special Marriage Act, 1954, which supplies a civil route across religions, so the residual resistance must be social rather than merely legal. Add the reproduction point that endogamy remains the least-changed of the four defining features, so neither trend implies that caste is dissolving. Qualify explicitly against the marriage-trend generalisation risk: the premise is hedged as increasing only to some extent and is not a national prevalence series. Conclude that the two boundaries erode at different speeds because they are guarded by different things: status and resources on one side, identity and belonging on the other. Why this earns marks: it answers the comparative demand, supplies the mechanism for each side, names the civil route that defeats the lazy personal-law explanation, and keeps the qualified premise intact.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I Q9", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Frame the divergence rather than marriage change in general. Claim one: parity loosens the caste boundary, because where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which converts caste boundary-crossing into a status calculation; the qualification is that the premise is explicitly hedged as increasing only to some extent and is not a national prevalence series. Claim two: belonging holds the religious boundary, because interreligious marriage engages community identity, kinship networks and family sanction that economic parity does not remove; the named evidence that personal-law plurality alone is insufficient is the Special Marriage Act, 1954, which supplies a civil route across religions, so the residual resistance must be social rather than merely legal. Add the reproduction point that endogamy remains the least-changed of the four defining features, so neither trend implies that caste is dissolving. Qualify explicitly against the marriage-trend generalisation risk: the premise is hedged as increasing only to some extent and is not a national prevalence series. Conclude that the two boundaries erode at different speeds because they are guarded by different things: status and resources on one side, identity and belonging on the other. Why this earns marks: it answers the comparative demand, supplies the mechanism for each side, names the civil route that defeats the lazy personal-law explanation, and keeps the qualified premise intact.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Intercaste marriages between castes which have socio-economic parity have increased, to some extent, but this is less true of interreligious marriages. Discuss. (Answer in 150 words) 10 marks. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Status: Verified verbatim in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger and in the locally held official 2024 General Studies Paper-I. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or

legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Frame the divergence rather than marriage change in general. Claim one: parity loosens the caste boundary, because where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which converts caste boundary-crossing into a status calculation; the qualification is that the premise is explicitly hedged as increasing only to some extent and is not a national prevalence series. Claim two: belonging holds the religious boundary, because interreligious marriage engages community identity, kinship networks and family sanction that economic parity does not remove; the named evidence that personal-law plurality alone is insufficient is the Special Marriage Act, 1954, which supplies a civil route across religions, so the residual resistance must be social rather than merely legal. Add the reproduction point that endogamy remains the least-changed of the four defining features, so neither trend implies that caste is dissolving. Qualify explicitly against the marriage-trend generalisation risk: the premise is hedged as increasing only to some extent and is not a national prevalence series. Conclude that the two boundaries erode at different speeds because they are guarded by different things: status and resources on one side, identity and belonging on the other. Why this earns marks: it answers the comparative demand, supplies the mechanism for each side, names the civil route that defeats the lazy personal-law explanation, and keeps the qualified premise intact.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I Q9", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 GS-I Q8

Demand: "Caste system is assuming new identities and associational forms. Hence, caste system cannot be eradicated in India." Comment. (Answer in 150 words) 10 marks.

Status: Routed in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger to the Advanced owner with Core routing recorded as superseding; wording confirmed in the locally held official General Studies Paper-I.

Model solution: Open by accepting the observation and contesting the inference. Claim one: the register has changed, because occupational allocation, service ties and public purity enforcement have weakened under urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment, which proves that the ritual-economic scaffolding is not what now carries caste; the qualification is that stigmatised occupations and their inheritance persist. Claim two: the replacement is organisational, because caste associations and jati panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms, run welfare and educational trusts and organise electoral mobilisation, which proves caste re-entering public life as network and interest rather than as ritual rank; the qualification is that this does not make caste equivalent to ethnicity, since hierarchy and endogamy persist. Claim three: what did not change is endogamy and intimate-sphere discrimination, which is why associational vitality coexists with an unbroken marriage boundary. Comment on the inference: the premise supports the conclusion that caste is not disappearing, but eradication is a normative-institutional question rather than an empirical prediction, and reservation and atrocity-protection doctrine belongs to Polity and Social Justice rather than to a Society answer. Why this earns marks: it separates observation from inference, gives old form, replacement and residue in order, and refuses both the disappearance and the fatalism thesis.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 GS-I Q8", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Open by accepting the observation and contesting the inference. Claim one: the register has changed, because occupational allocation, service ties and public purity enforcement have weakened under urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment, which proves that the ritual-economic scaffolding is not what now carries caste; the qualification is that stigmatised occupations and their inheritance persist. Claim two: the replacement is organisational, because caste associations and jati panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms, run welfare and educational trusts and organise electoral mobilisation, which proves caste re-entering public life as network and interest rather than as ritual rank; the qualification is that this does not make caste equivalent to ethnicity, since hierarchy and endogamy persist. Claim three: what did not change is endogamy and intimate-sphere discrimination, which is why associational vitality coexists with an unbroken marriage boundary. Comment on the inference: the premise supports the conclusion that caste is not disappearing, but eradication is a normative-institutional question rather than an empirical prediction, and reservation and atrocity-protection doctrine belongs to Polity and Social Justice rather than to a Society answer. Why this earns marks: it separates observation from inference, gives old form, replacement and residue in order, and refuses both the disappearance and the fatalism thesis.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: "Caste system is assuming new identities and associational forms. Hence, caste system cannot be eradicated in India." Comment. (Answer in 150 words) 10 marks. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Routed in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger to the Advanced owner with Core routing recorded as superseding; wording confirmed in the locally held official General Studies Paper-I. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Open by accepting the observation and contesting the inference. Claim one: the register has changed, because occupational allocation, service ties and public purity enforcement have weakened under urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment, which proves that the ritual-economic scaffolding is not what now carries caste; the qualification is that stigmatised occupations and their inheritance persist. Claim two: the replacement is organisational, because caste associations and jati panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms, run welfare and educational trusts and organise electoral mobilisation, which proves caste re-entering public life as network and interest rather than as ritual rank; the qualification is that this does not make caste equivalent to ethnicity, since hierarchy and endogamy persist. Claim three: what did not change is endogamy and intimate-sphere discrimination, which is why associational vitality coexists with an unbroken marriage boundary. Comment on the inference: the premise supports the conclusion that caste is not disappearing, but eradication is a normative-institutional question rather than an empirical prediction, and reservation and atrocity-protection doctrine belongs to Polity and Social Justice rather than to a Society answer. Why this earns marks: it separates observation from inference, gives old form, replacement and residue in order, and refuses both the disappearance and the fatalism thesis.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 GS-I Q8", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2020 GS-I Q8

Demand: Has caste lost its relevance in understanding the multi-cultural Indian Society? Elaborate your answer with illustrations. (Answer in 150 words) 10 marks.

Status: Routed in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger to the Advanced owner with Core routing recorded as superseding; wording confirmed in the locally held official General Studies Paper-I.

Model solution: Answer that caste has not lost relevance because it is the axis on which India's plurality is stratified rather than merely differentiated, and elaborate across four arenas. Marriage: endogamy remains the most consistently observed defining feature and operates with gotra exogamy, which proves that the most intimate arena is still caste-governed. Ritual and stigma: locally ranked purity and pollution notions still order interaction in many settings, with the qualification that rank order varies regionally and cannot be stated as one national ladder. Economy: occupational decoupling is real under urban and non-farm employment, yet caste-class overlap persists unevenly and cross-cutting differentiation now appears inside single castes, which proves relevance without determinism. Politics: caste associations and dominant castes convert numbers, land and office into local authority, which proves that caste organises interest as well as status. Conclude that caste is analytically indispensable for a multi-cultural society precisely because plurality without stratification would be a different problem, while conceding that its form has shifted from allocation to association. Why this earns marks: it uses four illustrated arenas rather than assertions, concedes the genuine change, and states the exact reason relevance survives.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2020 GS-I Q8", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Answer that caste has not lost relevance because it is the axis on which India's plurality is stratified rather than merely differentiated, and elaborate across four arenas. Marriage: endogamy remains the most consistently observed defining feature and operates with gotra exogamy, which proves that the most intimate arena is still caste-governed. Ritual and stigma: locally ranked purity and pollution notions still order interaction in many settings, with the qualification that rank order varies regionally and cannot be stated as one national ladder. Economy: occupational decoupling is real under urban and non-farm employment, yet caste-class overlap persists unevenly and cross-cutting differentiation now appears inside single castes, which proves relevance without determinism. Politics: caste associations and dominant castes convert numbers, land and office into local authority, which proves that caste organises interest as well as status. Conclude that caste is analytically indispensable for a multi-cultural society precisely because plurality without stratification would be a different problem, while conceding that its form has shifted from allocation to association. Why this earns marks: it uses four illustrated arenas rather than assertions, concedes the genuine change, and states the exact reason relevance survives.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Has caste lost its relevance in understanding the multi-cultural Indian Society? Elaborate your answer with illustrations. (Answer in 150 words) 10 marks. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Routed in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger to the Advanced owner with Core routing recorded as superseding; wording confirmed in the locally held official General Studies Paper-I. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Answer that caste has not lost relevance because it is the axis on which India's plurality is stratified rather than merely differentiated, and elaborate across four arenas. Marriage: endogamy remains the most consistently observed defining feature and operates with gotra exogamy, which proves that the most intimate arena is

still caste-governed. Ritual and stigma: locally ranked purity and pollution notions still order interaction in many settings, with the qualification that rank order varies regionally and cannot be stated as one national ladder. Economy: occupational decoupling is real under urban and non-farm employment, yet caste-class overlap persists unevenly and cross-cutting differentiation now appears inside single castes, which proves relevance without determinism. Politics: caste associations and dominant castes convert numbers, land and office into local authority, which proves that caste organises interest as well as status. Conclude that caste is analytically indispensable for a multi-cultural society precisely because plurality without stratification would be a different problem, while conceding that its form has shifted from allocation to association. Why this earns marks: it uses four illustrated arenas rather than assertions, concedes the genuine change, and states the exact reason relevance survives.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2020 GS-I Q8”, replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 GS-I Q18

Demand: Analyse the salience of 'sect' in Indian society vis-a-vis caste, region and religion. (Answer in 250 words) 15 marks.

Status: Routed in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger to the Advanced owner with Core routing recorded as superseding; wording confirmed in the locally held official General Studies Paper-I.

Model solution: Begin by refusing a single national ranking and defining the units precisely. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following constituted by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation; a jati is a birth-ascribed endogamous group; a religion is a faith community; a region is a territorial-cultural group. Analyse arena by arena. Marriage and local status: jati and sub-jati decide the boundary through endogamy, so sect salience is low here even when a jati is concentrated in one sect. Devotional life and shrine politics: sect is decisive, because doctrine, lineage and sacred-site control organise the arena. Electoral mobilisation: jati clusters and religion usually dominate, with sect entering where a sacred site or lineage becomes a political resource. Development grievance: region and language dominate, which is why sect rarely frames disparity claims. Add the overlap caution that a jati concentrated in a sect does not make the two the same kind of unit, since one is a birth-and-marriage axis and the other a voluntary or inherited following. Conclude that sect is a real but arena-bounded axis whose salience rises in ritual and sacred-site contexts and falls in marriage and disparity contexts, so the correct verdict is contextual salience rather than a hierarchy of identities. Why this earns marks: it defines four competing units, ranks them by arena with reasons, resists a false single ranking, and supplies the overlap caution examiners look for.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 GS-I Q18”, all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Begin by refusing a single national ranking and defining the units precisely. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following constituted by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation; a jati is a birth-ascribed endogamous group; a religion is a faith community; a region is a territorial-cultural group. Analyse arena by arena. Marriage and local status: jati and sub-jati decide the boundary through endogamy, so sect salience is low here even when a jati is concentrated in one sect. Devotional life and shrine politics: sect is decisive, because doctrine, lineage and sacred-site control organise the arena. Electoral mobilisation: jati clusters and religion usually dominate, with sect entering where a sacred site or lineage becomes a political resource. Development grievance: region and language dominate, which is why sect rarely frames disparity claims. Add the overlap caution that a jati concentrated in a sect does not make the two the same kind of unit, since one is a birth-and-marriage axis and the other a voluntary or inherited following. Conclude that sect is a real but arena-bounded axis whose salience rises in ritual and sacred-site contexts and falls in marriage and disparity contexts, so the correct verdict is contextual salience rather than a hierarchy of identities. Why this earns marks: it defines four competing units, ranks them by arena with

reasons, resists a false single ranking, and supplies the overlap caution examiners look for.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Analyse the salience of 'sect' in Indian society vis-a-vis caste, region and religion. (Answer in 250 words) 15 marks. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Routed in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger to the Advanced owner with Core routing recorded as superseding; wording confirmed in the locally held official General Studies Paper-I. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Begin by refusing a single national ranking and defining the units precisely. A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following constituted by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation; a jati is a birth-ascribed endogamous group; a religion is a faith community; a region is a territorial-cultural group. Analyse arena by arena. Marriage and local status: jati and sub-jati decide the boundary through endogamy, so sect salience is low here even when a jati is concentrated in one sect. Devotional life and shrine politics: sect is decisive, because doctrine, lineage and sacred-site control organise the arena. Electoral mobilisation: jati clusters and religion usually dominate, with sect entering where a sacred site or lineage becomes a political resource. Development grievance: region and language dominate, which is why sect rarely frames disparity claims. Add the overlap caution that a jati concentrated in a sect does not make the two the same kind of unit, since one is a birth-and-marriage axis and the other a voluntary or inherited following. Conclude that sect is a real but arena-bounded axis whose salience rises in ritual and sacred-site contexts and falls in marriage and disparity contexts, so the correct verdict is contextual salience rather than a hierarchy of identities. Why this earns marks: it defines four competing units, ranks them by arena with reasons, resists a false single ranking, and supplies the overlap caution examiners look for.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 GS-I Q18", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2023 GS-I Q19

Demand: Why is caste identity in India both fluid and static? (Answer in 250 words) 15 marks.

Status: Routed in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger to the Advanced owner with Core routing recorded as superseding; wording confirmed in the locally held official General Studies Paper-I.

Model solution: Open with the level thesis: caste is fluid in rank and static in boundary. Build the static layer first. Endogamy is the most consistently observed defining feature and, with gotra exogamy, reproduces the group every generation; hereditary membership and residential and marital segregation reinforce it; this proves that the mechanism of reproduction has changed least. Build the fluid layer next. Sanskritisation, described by M.N. Srinivas from Rampura fieldwork in Karnataka, lets a jati claim higher local rank by adopting the practices of a locally higher-status caste, with the qualification that it is a claim rather than proof of acceptance; dominance built on numbers, land and office allows a middle-ranked jati to exercise local power above its ritual rank; urban labour markets recruit on credentials and have broken most hereditary occupational allocation; caste associations reinvent the group as an electoral and welfare network. Give the explanation the directive demands: rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed and locally contested, whereas the boundary is not, because it is reproduced through

marriage rather than through opinion. Add the measurement point that no all-India jati count may be quoted and that the Census 2027 caste enumeration announced on 30 April 2025 is prospective. Conclude that fluidity and rigidity are not a contradiction but a division of labour between status and reproduction. Why this earns marks: it explains rather than lists, separates two layers with named evidence, and answers the why directive with a mechanism.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2023 GS-I Q19”, all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Open with the level thesis: caste is fluid in rank and static in boundary. Build the static layer first. Endogamy is the most consistently observed defining feature and, with gotra exogamy, reproduces the group every generation; hereditary membership and residential and marital segregation reinforce it; this proves that the mechanism of reproduction has changed least. Build the fluid layer next. Sanskritisation, described by M.N. Srinivas from Rampura fieldwork in Karnataka, lets a jati claim higher local rank by adopting the practices of a locally higher-status caste, with the qualification that it is a claim rather than proof of acceptance; dominance built on numbers, land and office allows a middle-ranked jati to exercise local power above its ritual rank; urban labour markets recruit on credentials and have broken most hereditary occupational allocation; caste associations reinvent the group as an electoral and welfare network. Give the explanation the directive demands: rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed and locally contested, whereas the boundary is not, because it is reproduced through marriage rather than through opinion. Add the measurement point that no all-India jati count may be quoted and that the Census 2027 caste enumeration announced on 30 April 2025 is prospective. Conclude that fluidity and rigidity are not a contradiction but a division of labour between status and reproduction. Why this earns marks: it explains rather than lists, separates two layers with named evidence, and answers the why directive with a mechanism.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Why is caste identity in India both fluid and static? (Answer in 250 words) 15 marks. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Routed in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger to the Advanced owner with Core routing recorded as superseding; wording confirmed in the locally held official General Studies Paper-I. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Open with the level thesis: caste is fluid in rank and static in boundary. Build the static layer first. Endogamy is the most consistently observed defining feature and, with gotra exogamy, reproduces the group every generation; hereditary membership and residential and marital segregation reinforce it; this proves that the mechanism of reproduction has changed least. Build the fluid layer next. Sanskritisation, described by M.N. Srinivas from Rampura fieldwork in Karnataka, lets a jati claim higher local rank by adopting the practices of a locally higher-status caste, with the qualification that it is a claim rather than proof of acceptance; dominance built on numbers, land and office allows a middle-ranked jati to exercise local power above its ritual rank; urban labour markets recruit on credentials and have broken most hereditary occupational allocation; caste associations reinvent the group as an electoral and welfare network. Give the explanation the directive demands: rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed and locally contested, whereas the boundary is not, because it is reproduced through marriage rather than through opinion. Add the measurement point that no all-India jati count may be quoted and that the Census 2027 caste enumeration announced on 30 April 2025 is prospective. Conclude that fluidity and rigidity are not a contradiction but a division of labour between status and reproduction. Why this earns marks: it explains rather than lists, separates two layers with named evidence, and answers the why directive with a mechanism.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named

evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2023 GS-I Q19”, replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain how caste is assuming new identities and associational forms in contemporary India. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Caste is changing register rather than disappearing: ritual allocation and public purity enforcement have weakened while association, network capital and political mobilisation have expanded, and endogamy has changed least.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates.
- Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared.
- Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual.
- An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis.
- Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

Qualified conclusion: Caste is changing register rather than disappearing: ritual allocation and public purity enforcement have weakened while association, network capital and political mobilisation have expanded, and endogamy has changed least.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on “Explain how caste is assuming new identities and associational forms in contemporary India....”, all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Caste is changing register rather than disappearing: ritual allocation and public purity enforcement have weakened while association, network capital and political mobilisation have expanded, and endogamy has changed least.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network

rather than as ritual. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Caste is changing register rather than disappearing: ritual allocation and public purity enforcement have weakened while association, network capital and political mobilisation have expanded, and endogamy has changed least.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For “Explain how caste is assuming new identities and associational forms in contemporary India...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish Sanskritisation from Westernisation with Indian examples. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Sanskritisation is upward emulation inside an existing local hierarchy while Westernisation introduces new values that can subvert that hierarchy, so the two processes can coexist in one community without being the same thing.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.
- Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy.
- Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.

Qualified conclusion: Sanskritisation is upward emulation inside an existing local hierarchy while Westernisation introduces new values that can subvert that hierarchy, so the two processes can coexist in one community without being the same thing.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Distinguish Sanskritisation from Westernisation with Indian examples. Answer in about 150...”, all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a

qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Sanskritisation is upward emulation inside an existing local hierarchy while Westernisation introduces new values that can subvert that hierarchy, so the two processes can coexist in one community without being the same thing.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Sanskritisation is upward emulation inside an existing local hierarchy while Westernisation introduces new values that can subvert that hierarchy, so the two processes can coexist in one community without being the same thing.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish Sanskritisation from Westernisation with Indian examples. Answer in about 150...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Why is caste identity in India simultaneously negotiable in rank and rigid in boundary? Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, land, office and market position, while the boundary is rigid because marriage reproduces it, which is why rising intercaste marriage and undiminished caste identity can coexist.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

- M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.
- A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank.
- Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared.
- Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

Qualified conclusion: Rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, land, office and market position, while the boundary is rigid because marriage reproduces it, which is why rising intercaste marriage and undiminished caste identity can coexist.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Why is caste identity in India simultaneously negotiable in rank and rigid in boundary?...”, all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, land, office and market position, while the boundary is rigid because marriage reproduces it, which is why rising intercaste marriage and undiminished caste identity can coexist.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, land, office and market position, while the boundary is rigid because marriage reproduces it, which is why rising intercaste marriage and undiminished caste identity can coexist.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For “Why is caste identity in India simultaneously negotiable in rank and rigid in boundary?...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess the dominant caste as a tool for analysing local power in India. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The dominant caste explains everyday authority better than ritual rank because it fuses numbers, land and office, but reserved representation and market differentiation now contest it without eliminating it.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank.
- Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.
- Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.
- Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual.

Qualified conclusion: The dominant caste explains everyday authority better than ritual rank because it fuses numbers, land and office, but reserved representation and market differentiation now contest it without eliminating it.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess the dominant caste as a tool for analysing local power in India. Answer in about 250...”, all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The dominant caste explains everyday authority better than ritual rank because it fuses numbers, land and office, but reserved representation and market differentiation now contest it without eliminating it.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social

outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The dominant caste explains everyday authority better than ritual rank because it fuses numbers, land and office, but reserved representation and market differentiation now contest it without eliminating it.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the dominant caste as a tool for analysing local power in India. Answer in about 250...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate whether caste today is best understood as hierarchy, as identity or as network. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: No single reading covers all four arenas, because hierarchy still governs marriage and stigma, identity governs mobilisation, and network governs urban opportunity, so the honest verdict is arena-specific rather than a single definition.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit.
- Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.
- An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis.
- Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance.
- Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual.
- Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.

Qualified conclusion: No single reading covers all four arenas, because hierarchy still governs marriage and stigma, identity governs mobilisation, and network governs urban opportunity, so the honest verdict is arena-specific rather than a single definition.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on “Evaluate whether caste today is best understood as hierarchy, as identity or as network...”, all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: No single reading covers all four arenas, because hierarchy still governs marriage and stigma, identity governs mobilisation, and network governs urban opportunity, so the honest verdict is arena-specific rather than a single definition.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit.
Analysis: Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.
Analysis: Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: No single reading covers all four arenas, because hierarchy still governs marriage and stigma, identity governs mobilisation, and network governs urban opportunity, so the honest verdict is arena-specific rather than a single definition.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For “Evaluate whether caste today is best understood as hierarchy, as identity or as network...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Examine why the caste boundary and the religious boundary in marriage erode at different speeds. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Parity is loosening the caste boundary because it protects status and resources, while belonging holds the religious boundary because it protects community identity, and the availability of a civil route shows that legal plurality alone is not the explanation.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings.
- The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead.
- A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit.
- Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.

Qualified conclusion: Parity is loosening the caste boundary because it protects status and resources, while belonging holds the religious boundary because it protects community identity, and the availability of a civil route shows that legal plurality alone is not the explanation.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on “Examine why the caste boundary and the religious boundary in marriage erode at different...”, all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Parity is loosening the caste boundary because it protects status and resources, while belonging holds the religious boundary because it protects community identity, and the availability of a civil route shows that legal plurality alone is not the explanation.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism ->

differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication.

Qualification: State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Parity is loosening the caste boundary because it protects status and resources, while belonging holds the religious boundary because it protects community identity, and the availability of a civil route shows that legal plurality alone is not the explanation.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

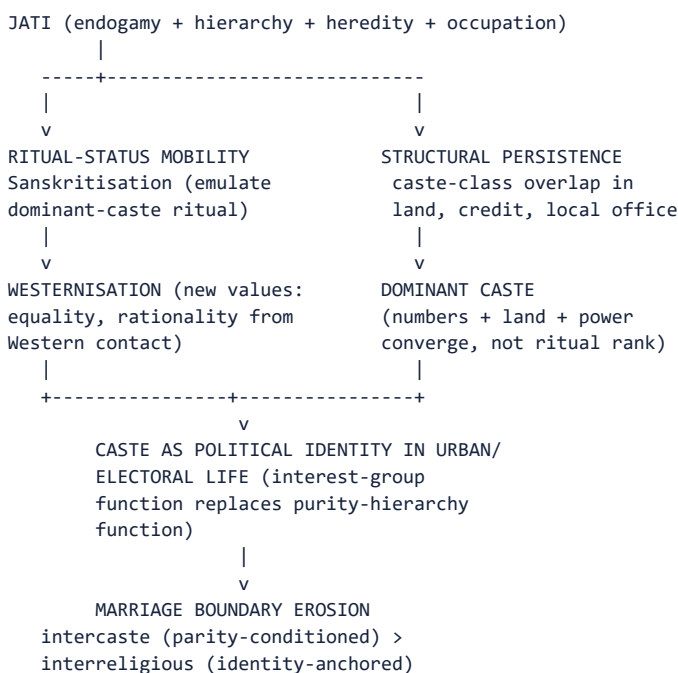
Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For “Examine why the caste boundary and the religious boundary in marriage erode at different...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Indian Society | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-I. **Core area:** Caste as political identity in urban/electoral life, the caste-class overlap debate, boundary cases in caste mobility, and the intercaste-versus-interreligious marriage divide. **Grounded in:** M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation/dominant-caste framework; Census 2027 Gazette/PIB caste-enumeration announcement; audited 2024 GS-I Mains PYQ. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = current anchor. *Companion:* basic/02_Caste-System-Structure-and-Contemporary-Dynamics.md.

1. Architecture



Analytical claim: ANALYSIS: Caste mobility today runs on two parallel tracks - ritual-status emulation (Sanskritisation) and structural power convergence (dominant caste) - and these tracks do not always move together: a jati can Sanskritise its rituals while remaining economically weak, or a caste can gain political dominance without ritual-status change; the 2024 PYQ's marriage-boundary question should be treated as a qualified pattern: status parity can ease some intercaste matches, while community, kinship and religious-identity constraints can make interreligious matches harder in particular contexts.

2. Concepts and distinctions

Concept	Precise meaning
FACT: Sanskritisation vs Westernisation	Sanskritisation is upward emulation <i>within</i> the existing local hierarchy (adopting a dominant caste's rituals); Westernisation introduces <i>new</i> values (equality, individual rights, rationality) that can subvert, rather than reinforce, the hierarchy Sanskritisation assumes.
FACT: Dominant caste vs ritually superior caste	Dominance is defined by numbers, land ownership and political office in a locality; ritual superiority is defined by position in the purity-pollution hierarchy - the two frequently diverge, and dominance is the better predictor of everyday local power.
ANALYSIS: Caste-class overlap vs caste-class cross-cutting	Overlap describes regions/periods where caste rank and economic class coincide (reinforcing disadvantage); cross-cutting describes cases where class differentiation occurs <i>within</i> a caste (a caste with both prosperous and poor members), which is increasingly common with urbanisation and market employment.
ANALYSIS: Caste as hierarchy vs caste as political identity	The classical (Dumont-style) view treats caste as a religiously sanctioned purity hierarchy; contemporary political sociology also studies caste as a mobilised interest and network in urban and electoral settings. The latter does not make caste identical to ethnicity or remove the continuing relevance of hierarchy and endogamy.
ANALYSIS: Status-parity versus community-boundary explanations of marriage	The 2024 PYQ proposes a qualified pattern: parity can ease some intercaste matches, while interreligious matches may face additional family, community and identity constraints. Treat this as an analytical proposition, not a universal causal law or a national prevalence estimate.

3. Detailed causal chain

Ritual-mobility chain (Sanskritisation)

1. A jati acquires new economic resources (trade, migration income, education).
2. It adopts ritual, dietary or marriage practices associated with a locally higher-status caste; the practices and their local reception vary.
3. It claims a higher position in the local hierarchy without waiting for external reclassification.
4. ANALYSIS: Success depends on the dominant caste's tacit acceptance and on the jati's ability to sustain the new economic base - Sanskritisation without durable resources tends to stall.

Structural-power chain (dominant caste)

1. A caste acquires numerical strength and landholding in a region (often through land reform beneficiary status or agricultural surplus).
2. It converts this into control of Panchayati Raj offices and local political networks.
3. Its local dominance can then persist even where it does not rank highest ritually, because power now rests on votes and land, not purity status.
4. ANALYSIS: This dominance can itself become a source of friction with numerically smaller but ritually higher castes, or with Scheduled Castes seeking political voice.

Marriage-boundary chain (2024 PYQ)

1. Intercaste marriage between castes of similar socio-economic standing does not disturb either family's resource base or local status - acceptance rises.
2. Interreligious marriage may engage community identity, religious practice and family/community sanction in ways economic parity does not remove. The Special Marriage Act supplies a civil route, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain resistance.
3. ANALYSIS: The differential pattern in the PYQ is best tested against region, class, kinship and generation; it does not show that caste is now only a status calculation or that every religious boundary behaves alike.

4. Institutional and reform architecture

- ANALYSIS: **Caste associations as political intermediaries:** jati-level bodies increasingly function as vote-bank organisers and welfare-claim negotiators, converting a ritual category into a political constituency.
- ANALYSIS: **Caste-census debate (sociological, not enumeration-methodology):** demands for caste enumeration in the Census reflect a push to make caste-linked disadvantage statistically legible for policy targeting; whether and how this is executed is a Census/Polity administrative matter.
- FACT: **Reservation as a structural response (cross-linked, not restated):** constitutional reservation doctrine addresses caste disadvantage through affirmative action; its legal architecture belongs to Polity and Social-Justice/basic/07.
- ANALYSIS: **Urban caste persistence:** even where ritual practices weaken, caste-based networks persist in urban housing preferences, matrimonial markets and business partnerships, showing that caste networks can outlive, without replacing, ritual hierarchy.

5. Indian applications and boundary cases

- ANALYSIS: **Boundary case 1:** a Sanskritising jati that gains ritual respectability but remains economically poor shows that ritual mobility and structural mobility can diverge - Sanskritisation alone does not guarantee dominant-caste-level power.
- ANALYSIS: **Boundary case 2:** a numerically dominant but ritually middling caste controlling a state's political landscape (a recurring regional pattern) demonstrates dominance overriding ritual rank.

- ANALYSIS: **Boundary case 3:** an intercaste marriage between two economically equal trading-caste families that is quickly accepted by both sides, contrasted with an interreligious marriage between economically equal families that still faces resistance - directly illustrates the 2024 PYQ's asymmetry.

6. Limitations and trade-offs

- ANALYSIS: **Sanskritisation's ceiling:** emulation can raise local ritual standing but cannot by itself dismantle the structural (economic/political) disadvantage that reservation and redistribution address - a common Mains distinction between symbolic and substantive mobility.

- ANALYSIS: **Marriage-trend generalisation risk:** the 2024 PYQ's trend (rising intercaste, static interreligious) should not be read as uniform across India - regional, urban-rural and generational variation is substantial, and the PYQ itself only asserts a qualified "to some extent" trend.

7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims

- FACT: M.N. Srinivas developed both Sanskritisation and dominant caste from his Rampura (Karnataka) village fieldwork.

- FACT: Dominant caste is defined by numbers + land + political power, independent of ritual rank - a frequently tested distinction.

- FACT: Sanskritisation operates within the existing hierarchy; Westernisation introduces externally derived values - the two are analytically separate processes.

- FACT: The 2024 GS-I PYQ explicitly distinguishes intercaste (parity-conditioned, rising) from interreligious (identity-anchored, less so) marriage trends.

- CURRENT: The Government has announced caste enumeration in Census 2027. Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes reference dates at 1 October 2026 for specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere; no data exists as of 21 July 2026. This is not the first caste count in Indian history.

8. Advanced Prelims traps

- WRONG: Sanskritisation automatically produces economic upliftment. -> It is a ritual-status emulation process; economic mobility can accompany it but is not guaranteed by it.

- WRONG: Dominant caste means the same as "upper caste." -> Dominance can belong to a middle-ranked but numerous, land-owning caste; ritual "upper" status is a separate axis.

- WRONG: Caste-class overlap is total and unchanging. -> Urbanisation and market employment are producing class differentiation within many single castes, loosening the overlap.

- WRONG: The 2024 PYQ shows caste itself is disappearing. -> It shows conditional easing of intercaste-marriage resistance where socio-economic parity exists, not the disappearance of caste identity or caste networks more broadly.

9. CURRENT: Current-anchor note

- CURRENT: Census 2027's prospective caste-enumeration announcement is the dated anchor for this topic. The Gazette fixes 1 October 2026 for specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere; no caste-count outcome exists as of 21 July 2026. Do not call it India's first historical caste enumeration.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- FACT: **2024 GS-I (10 marks, verbatim):** "Intercaste marriages between castes which have socio-economic parity have increased, to some extent, but this is less true of interreligious marriages. Discuss." Analytical route: (a) apply the status-parity versus community-boundary distinction; (b) explain why parity may matter for some intercaste matches without universalising it; (c) explain interreligious resistance through community-belonging and kinship boundaries while noting the Special Marriage Act's civil route; (d) conclude that the qualified pattern needs region- and class-sensitive evidence, not a uniform "modernisation" story.

11. Mains-ready framework

Central thesis: Caste mobility today operates on two only-partly-linked tracks - ritual emulation (Sanskritisation) and structural power convergence (dominant caste). The 2024 marriage PYQ should be answered as a qualified, context-dependent pattern: status parity can matter, but community, kinship and regional norms can constrain both caste and religious boundary crossing.

1. Define varna, jati, endogamy, hierarchy and occupation-linkage precisely.
2. Introduce Sanskritisation and Westernisation as distinct, sometimes divergent, processes.
3. Introduce dominant caste as a power-convergence concept independent of ritual rank.
4. Apply status-parity and community-boundary explanations without treating either as universal.
5. Give one boundary case each for ritual mobility without structural mobility, and vice versa.
6. Flag the generalisation-risk limitation using the PYQ's own "to some extent" qualifier.
7. Cross-link, but do not restate, reservation/atrocities-law doctrine.
8. Recommend disaggregated, region-specific reading of caste-mobility and marriage-trend claims rather than a single national narrative.

12. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** In which village did M.N. Srinivas develop the concepts of Sanskritisation and dominant caste?
- FACT: **Mains (10 marks, 2024 GS-I PYQ, verbatim):** Intercaste marriages between castes which have socio-economic parity have increased, to some extent, but this is less true of interreligious marriages. Discuss.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** "Dominant caste status rests on power convergence, not ritual rank." Examine with reference to rural India.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** Distinguish between caste as a hierarchy and caste as a political identity in contemporary Indian politics.

13. Study links

- FACT: Foundation companion: `basic/02_Caste-System-Structure-and-Contemporary-Dynamics.md`.
- FACT: `advanced/05_Rural-Society-and-Agrarian-Change.md` - dominant caste in village power and jajmani-linked occupation (do not re-derive here).
- FACT: `advanced/04_Family-Marriage-and-Kinship.md` - the interreligious-marriage analytical half of the 2024 PYQ, treated in full there.
- FACT: `Social-Justice/basic/07_Scheduled-Castes-Rights-Atrocities-and-Welfare.md` - reservation and atrocities-law doctrine.
- FACT: `advanced/12_Social-Change-and-Modernisation.md` - Sanskritisation/Westernisation within the general theory of social change.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md`.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2020, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 4

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-I	8	Caste assuming new identities and associational forms	Comment · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2020	GS-I	8	Relevance of caste in understanding multi-cultural Indian society	Elaborate with illustrations · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-I	18	Salience of sect in Indian society against caste region and religion	Analyse · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-I	19	Caste identity in India as both fluid and static	Why · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Caste assuming new identities and associational forms
- Relevance of caste in understanding multi-cultural Indian society
- Salience of sect in Indian society against caste region and religion
- Caste identity in India as both fluid and static

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Caste System: Structure and Contemporary Dynamics: RAPID CONCEPT AND EVIDENCE MAP

1. **Varna as ideal type:** Varna is the four-fold classical order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra described in ancient texts; it is a normative ideological template rather than a directly observable social unit.
2. **Jati as the real unit:** Jati is the actual local, endogamous, birth-ascribed group that functions as India's real social unit of caste, and thousands of locally ranked jatis operate within or alongside the varna framework.
3. **Four defining features:** Endogamy, hierarchy, hereditary membership and traditional occupational linkage are the four classically cited defining features of caste, and they weaken at very different rates.
4. **Endogamy with gotra exogamy:** Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.
5. **Locally variable hierarchy:** Jatis are ranked locally by notions of purity and pollution, and the exact rank order can differ from region to region, which is why caste hierarchy is not a single pan-Indian ladder.
6. **Occupational decoupling:** Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared.
7. **Sanskritisation:** M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows.

8. **Westernisation:** Srinivas's Westernisation is change arising from sustained contact with Western, particularly British, values, technology and institutions, introducing new values such as equality and rationality instead of emulating an existing local hierarchy.
9. **Rampura fieldwork:** Srinivas derived both Sanskritisation and the dominant caste from fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka, which supplies the named-scholar spine every caste-mobility answer needs.
10. **Dominant caste:** A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank.
11. **Caste-class overlap and cross-cutting:** Overlap describes localities where caste rank and economic class coincide, while cross-cutting describes class differentiation inside a single caste, which is increasingly common with urban and market employment.
12. **Caste associations:** Jati-level associations and caste panchayats arbitrate disputes, enforce endogamy norms and organise political mobilisation, which is how caste re-enters public life as organisation and network rather than as ritual.
13. **Caste is not ethnicity:** An ethnic framing of caste drops hierarchy and endogamy, the two features that make caste analytically distinct, so caste-as-identity analysis supplements rather than replaces caste-as-hierarchy analysis.
14. **Fluid rank and rigid boundary:** Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations.
15. **Sect is not caste:** A sect, whether panth or sampradaya, is a religious following defined by doctrine, guru lineage and initiation rather than by birth-endogamy, so a sect can overlap with a jati without being the same kind of unit.
16. **Arena-specific salience:** Identity salience is arena-specific: jati dominates marriage and local status, sect dominates devotional and shrine politics, jati clusters and religion dominate electoral mobilisation, and region dominates development grievance.
17. **Status-parity marriage mechanism:** Where two jatis are of similar socio-economic standing, an alliance threatens neither family's status nor resource base, which is the mechanism behind rising acceptance of intercaste marriage in those settings.
18. **Special Marriage Act civil route:** The Special Marriage Act, 1954 supplies a civil route across religions, so personal-law plurality alone cannot explain the lower acceptance of interreligious marriage, and family sanction, kinship networks and community identity must be argued instead.
19. **Caste-census measurement status:** The Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration in Census 2027 and Gazette S.O. 2681(E) fixes its reference dates; the operation is prospective, no caste count exists to quote, and post-Independence Censuses not enumerating all castes does not make this India's first historical caste count.
20. **Verified direct Mains demands:** Five direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: 2024 on intercaste versus interreligious marriage worth 10 marks, 2018 on caste assuming new identities and associational forms worth 10, 2020 on caste's relevance in a multi-cultural society worth 10, 2022 on the salience of sect worth 15 and 2023 on caste identity being both fluid and static worth 15.

Caste System: Structure and Contemporary Dynamics: CLOSE-OPTION AND CAUSAL TRAPS

- Do not treat varna and jati as the same unit of analysis.
- Do not use Sanskritisation and Westernisation as synonyms for modernisation.
- Do not assume the dominant caste is the ritually highest caste.
- Do not claim that intercaste and interreligious marriage face equal acceptance.
- Do not read the qualified 2024 premise as a national prevalence series.
- Do not treat caste as identical to ethnicity by dropping hierarchy and endogamy.
- Do not claim uniform occupational decoupling across all castes and regions.

- Do not define caste-class overlap as an identity rather than an empirical tendency.
- Do not equate a sect with a jati merely because a jati is concentrated in one sect.
- Do not rank identity axes nationally instead of by arena.
- Do not re-derive reservation doctrine or atrocity law inside a Society answer.
- Do not quote a caste-count figure from the prospective Census 2027 enumeration.
- Do not call the announced caste enumeration India's first historical caste count.
- Do not present Sanskritisation as proof that acceptance or material mobility followed.

Caste System: Structure and Contemporary Dynamics: ANSWER-WRITING SPINE

DEFINE THE SOCIAL UNIT -> STATE THE BOUNDARY RULE AND WHO IS INCLUDED
 -> GROUP NAMED EVIDENCE BY MECHANISM OF REPRODUCTION OR CHANGE
 -> TEST COUNTER-CASES, REGIONAL VARIATION AND CATEGORY LIMITS
 -> SEPARATE CORRELATION FROM CAUSATION AND LAW FROM SOCIAL ACCEPTANCE
 -> CLOSE WITH A GRADED, POLICY-AWARE VERDICT AND A DATA CAVEAT

Caste System: Structure and Contemporary Dynamics: CURRENT-LINK AND DATA BOUNDARY

No additional live official item was verified for this topic on 2026-09-02. Only the dated official anchors already carried by the repository owners are used, each with its issuing body and date. The package invents no caste, tribe, demographic or agrarian statistic, no legal or constitutional claim and no policy status.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Level of analysis

VARNA -> four-fold textual ideal type, normative
 JATI -> local endogamous birth group, observable
 SUB-JATI -> narrower endogamy circle inside a jati
 RULE -> answer at the jati level, argue with the varna template
 MUST REMEMBER: Caste joins varna ideology, locally ranked jatis, endogamy, hereditary occupation, purity-pollution, social closure and power; Sanskritisation, dominant caste, secularisation, politicisation and caste-class mobility explain change without implying disappearance.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Four features and their rate of change

ENDOGAMY -> most consistently observed, changes least
 HIERARCHY -> locally ranked by purity and pollution
 HEREDITARY MEMBERSHIP -> fixed by birth
 OCCUPATION LINK -> weakest joint, broken by urban work

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Marriage rules that operate together

CASTE ENDOGAMY -> marry within the jati
GOTRA EXOGAMY -> marry outside the clan lineage
RESULT -> a bounded but non-consanguineous marriage circle
CONSEQUENCE -> caste is reproduced generation by generation

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Mobility strategies

SANSKRITISATION -> emulate a locally higher-status caste
EFFECT -> claims rank inside the existing hierarchy
WESTERNISATION -> new values from Western contact
EFFECT -> can subvert the hierarchy rather than confirm it

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Dominant caste test

NUMBERS -> is the caste locally numerous
LAND -> does it hold a significant share of local land
OFFICE -> does it control political and Panchayat positions
VERDICT -> dominance can sit below the ritual top

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Caste and class

OVERLAP -> caste rank and economic class coincide locally
CROSS-CUTTING -> rich and poor households inside one caste
DRIVER -> urban employment and market credentials
LIMIT -> the overlap is loosening, not abolished

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Associational reinvention

WEAKENED -> occupational allocation and public purity enforcement
REPLACED BY -> caste associations, trusts and electoral blocs
UNCHANGED -> endogamy and intimate-sphere discrimination
VERDICT -> change of register, not disappearance

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Fluid and static resolved by level

STATIC LAYER -> endogamy, hereditary membership, segregation
FLUID LAYER -> rank claims, dominance, market mobility
WHY -> rank is locally constructed, boundary is marital
ANSWER -> the paradox is a level distinction, not a contradiction

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Identity axes by arena

MARRIAGE -> jati and sub-jati decide the boundary
SHRINE AND DEVOTION -> sect through doctrine and lineage
ELECTORAL MOBILISATION -> jati clusters and religion
DEVELOPMENT GRIEVANCE -> region and language

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Two marriage boundaries

INTERCASTE -> parity protects status and resource base
INTERRELIGIOUS -> belonging, kinship and community sanction
CIVIL ROUTE -> Special Marriage Act, 1954 exists across religions
VERDICT -> different guards, therefore different speeds
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Varna is not jati, caste is not class, ritual rank is not identical to economic or political power, untouchability is not every caste inequality, and constitutional Scheduled Caste status is a legal-administrative category rather than a complete sociological map.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Measurement status

PIB 30 APRIL 2025 -> caste enumeration announced for Census 2027
GAZETTE S.O. 2681(E) -> fixes the reference dates
STATUS -> prospective, so no caste count may be quoted
LIMIT -> not India's first historical caste enumeration
EVIDENCE LIMIT: Articles 15-17, 46, 330-342A and reservation institutions set legal boundaries, but legal prohibition does not equal social eradication; compare Jat, Maratha, Patidar, Dalit and regional caste dynamics without homogenising communities or inferring causes from aggregate correlations.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Caste answer spine

OPEN -> name the level and the demand family
BODY -> structure, mobility, dominance, association
TENSION -> what changed against what did not
CLOSE -> arena-specific verdict with the measurement caveat